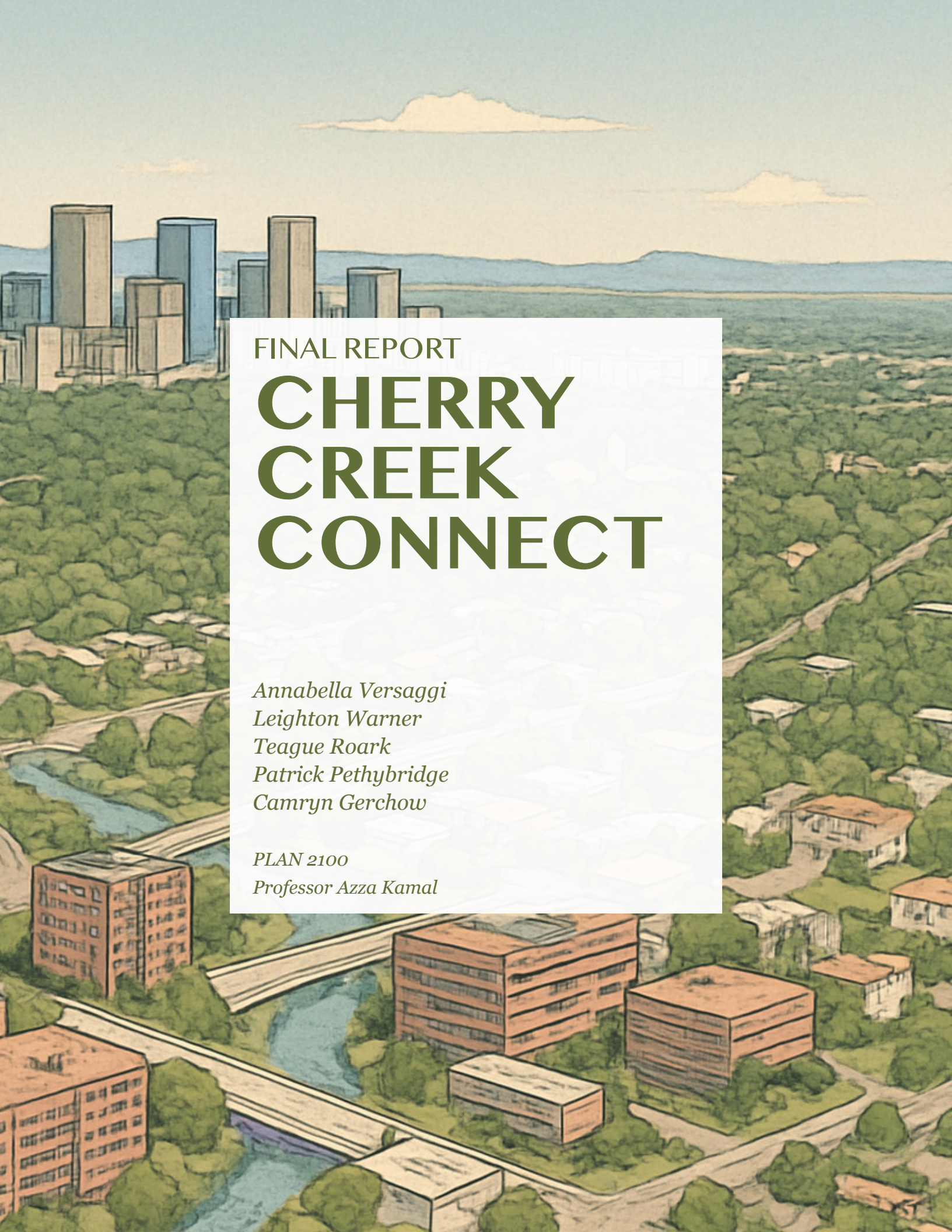


FINAL REPORT

CHERRY CREEK CONNECT

Annabella Versaggi
Leighton Warner
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Patrick Pethybridge
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PLAN 2100
Professor Azza Kamal

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MEET US



ANNABELLA VERSAGGI



LEIGHTON WARNER



TEAGUE ROARK



PATRICK PETHYBRIDGE



CAMRYN GERCHOW

THE CHERRY CREEK VISION

The Cherry Creek vision is a modern, sustainable, and well-connected neighborhood for all. It fosters a strong sense of community and inclusivity. The atmosphere will be inviting and refreshing with extensive access to green space using sustainable and innovative transit.

This will feature connective public spaces, revitalized commercial areas, and an abundance of green space.

GOALS

01 URBAN HEAT ISLAND EFFECT

02 SUSTAINABLE CONNECTIVITY

03 ACCESS TO GREEN SPACE

04 REVITALIZATION OF CHERRY CREEK MALL

ABOUT CHERRY CREEK









Cherry Creek is a great example of blending high-end residential, commercial, and recreational spaces in the heart of Denver. Over time, Cherry Creek has become extremely densified with mixed-use redevelopments popping up left and right over the past few decades. The plan of the neighborhood reflects a New Urbanist model with its primary focus on increasing pedestrian accessibility and connectivity.

The main attraction is the Cherry Creek Shopping Center in the southwest corner of the neighborhood, surrounded by mid- and high-rise apartments, high-end boutiques, and hotels. Over the past few years, however, the mall has experienced a massive decline in foot traffic and tourism. With three large abandoned buildings just next door surrounded by unused parking lots, the mall just isn't what it used to be.

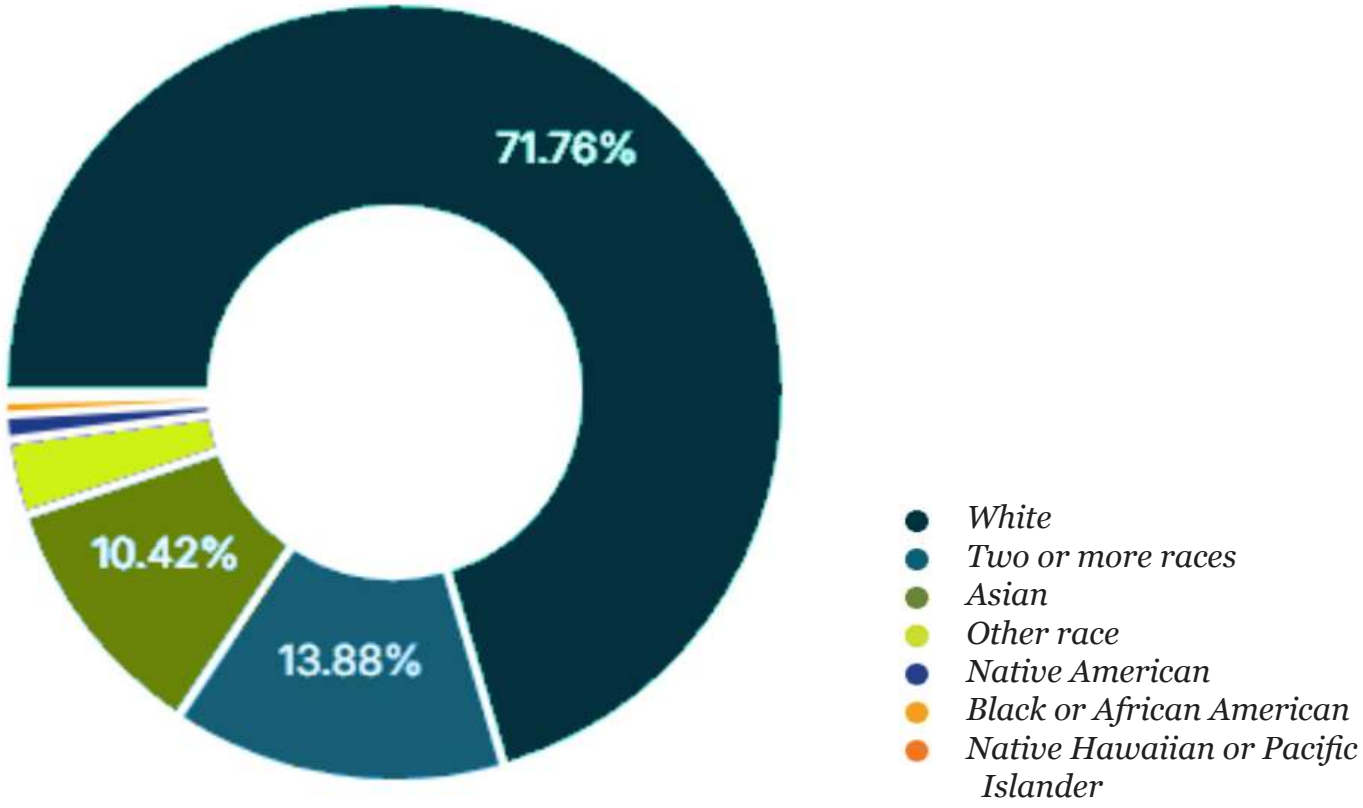
From a zoning and land-use perspective, Cherry Creek is learning to adapt to the high urban demand with larger apartment buildings and multi-family units. However, a large majority of the neighborhood is single-family residential which heavily impacts the potential growth of the currently successful urban development around the mall.

Urban planners in Cherry Creek are starting to focus on multi modal access through bike lanes, public transit, and general walkability. However, there are major concerns for the affordability of the neighborhood and potential gentrification starting to take place. The population's diversity has decreased exponentially since the redevelopment of the neighborhood has begun, weeding out middle and lower income residents.

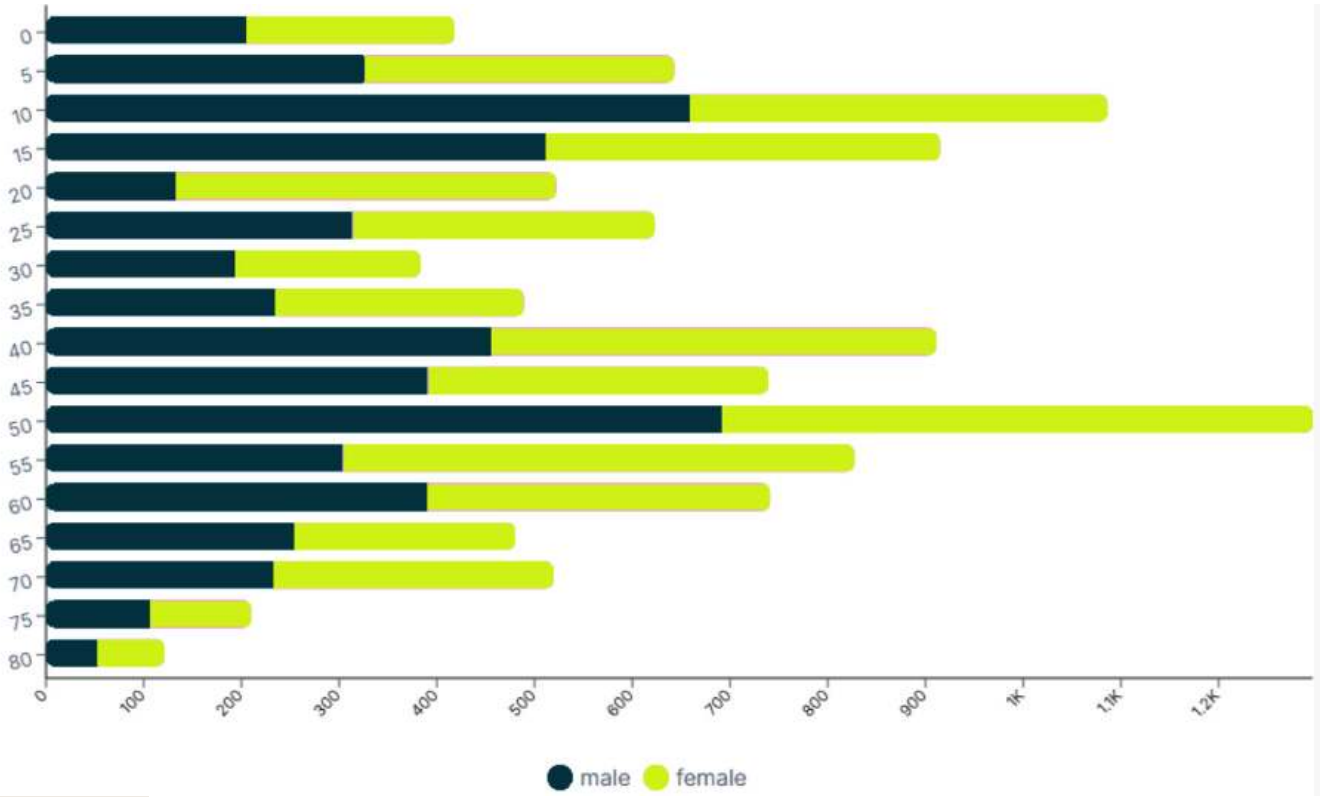
Overall, Cherry Creek continues to evolve as a model of upscale urban redevelopment while raising important concerns regarding inclusivity, resilience, and long-term sustainability in metropolitan growth.

DEMOGRAPHICS

Population by Race

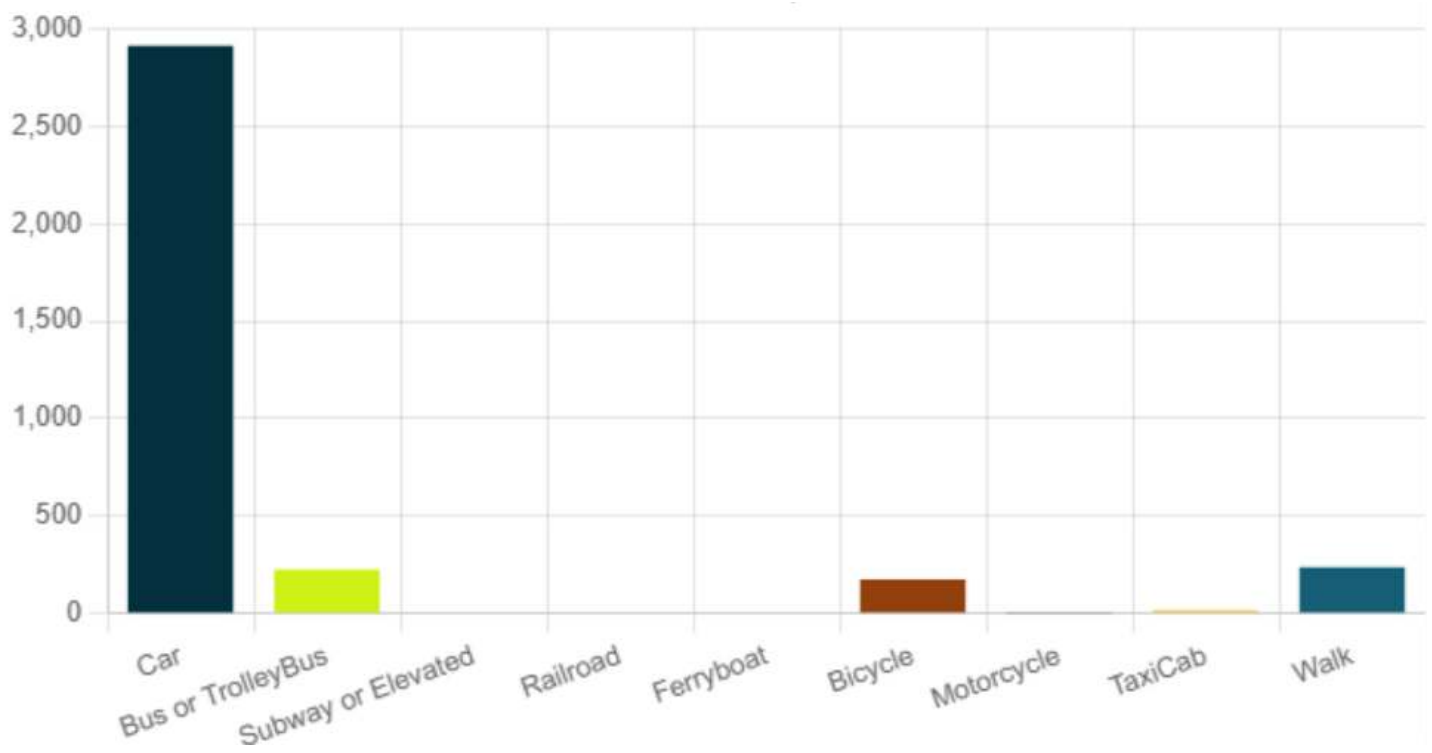


Population by Age



DEMOGRAPHICS

Means of Transport



Distribution of House Value in 2023



SWOT ANALYSIS

ACCESS TO RESOURCES

STRENGTHS

WEAKNESSES

OPPORTUNITIES

THREATS

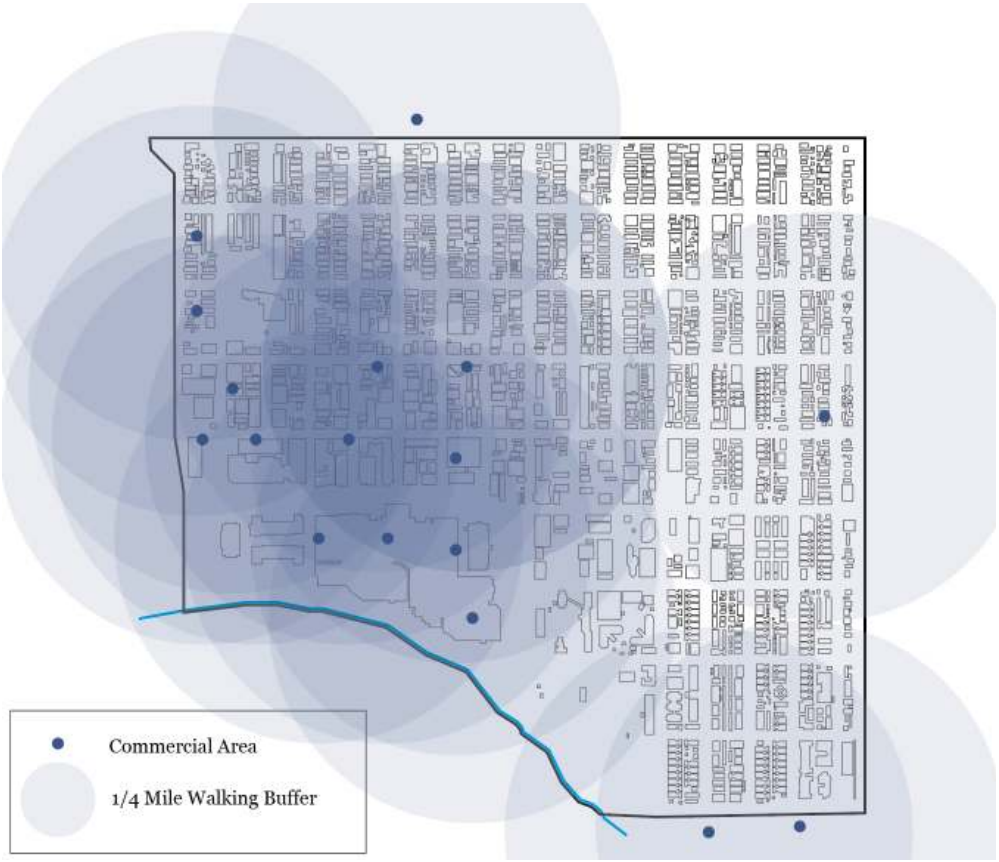
ACCESS TO RESOURCES

COMMERCIAL BUFFER ZONE

An analysis of the access to commercial activities showed that the northeast end of the site is lacking.

We will address this in our revitalization plan by building more commercial buildings and expanding vertically on existing commercial buildings.



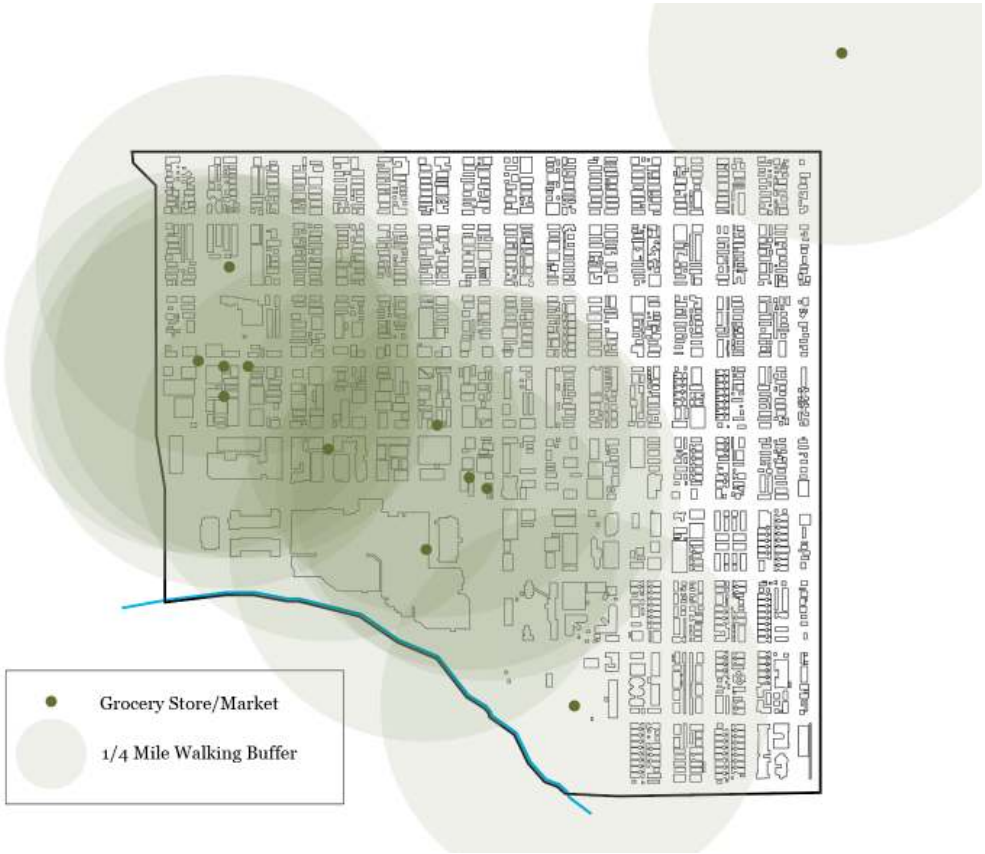


GROCERY BUFFER ZONE

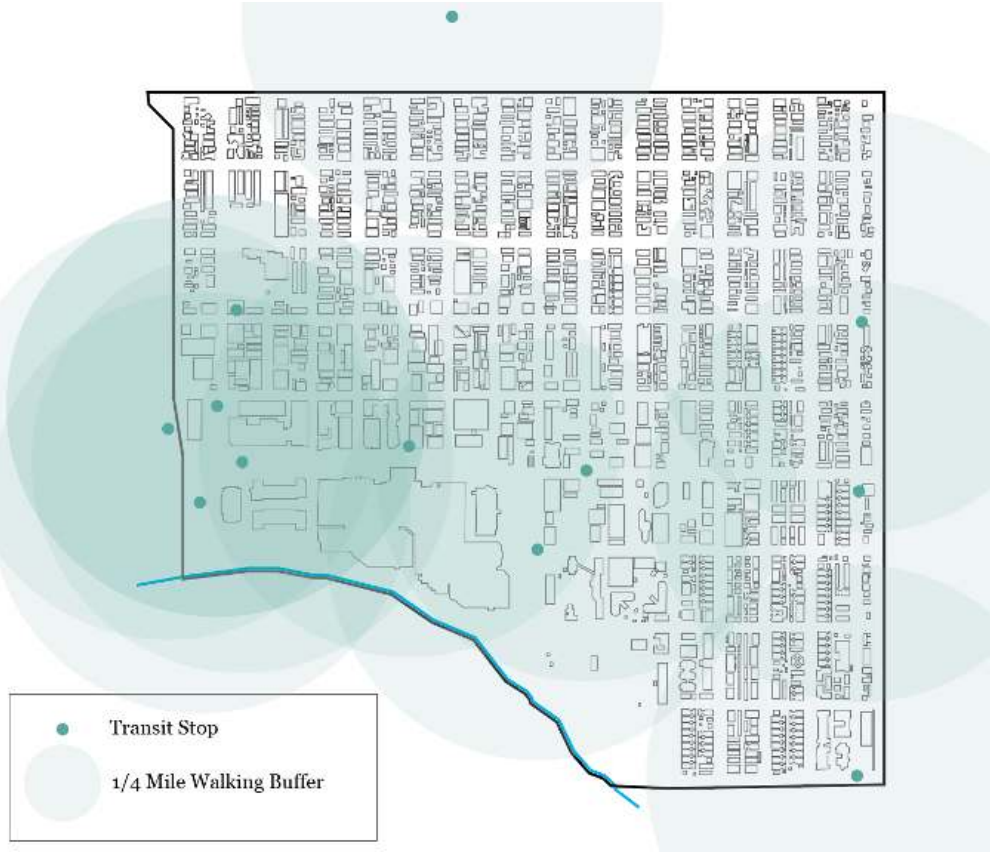
An analysis of the access to grocery stores showed that the northeast and southeast ends of the site are lacking.

To address this, we will implement more small markets and mixed use residential buildings in those corners.





ACCESS TO RESOURCES



TRANSIT STOP BUFFER ZONE

An analysis of the access to public transit in Cherry Creek showed that the northern residential areas are lacking in accessibility.

This will be addressed with the implementation of micro mobility hubs and additional bike lanes to reach the existing bus stops.





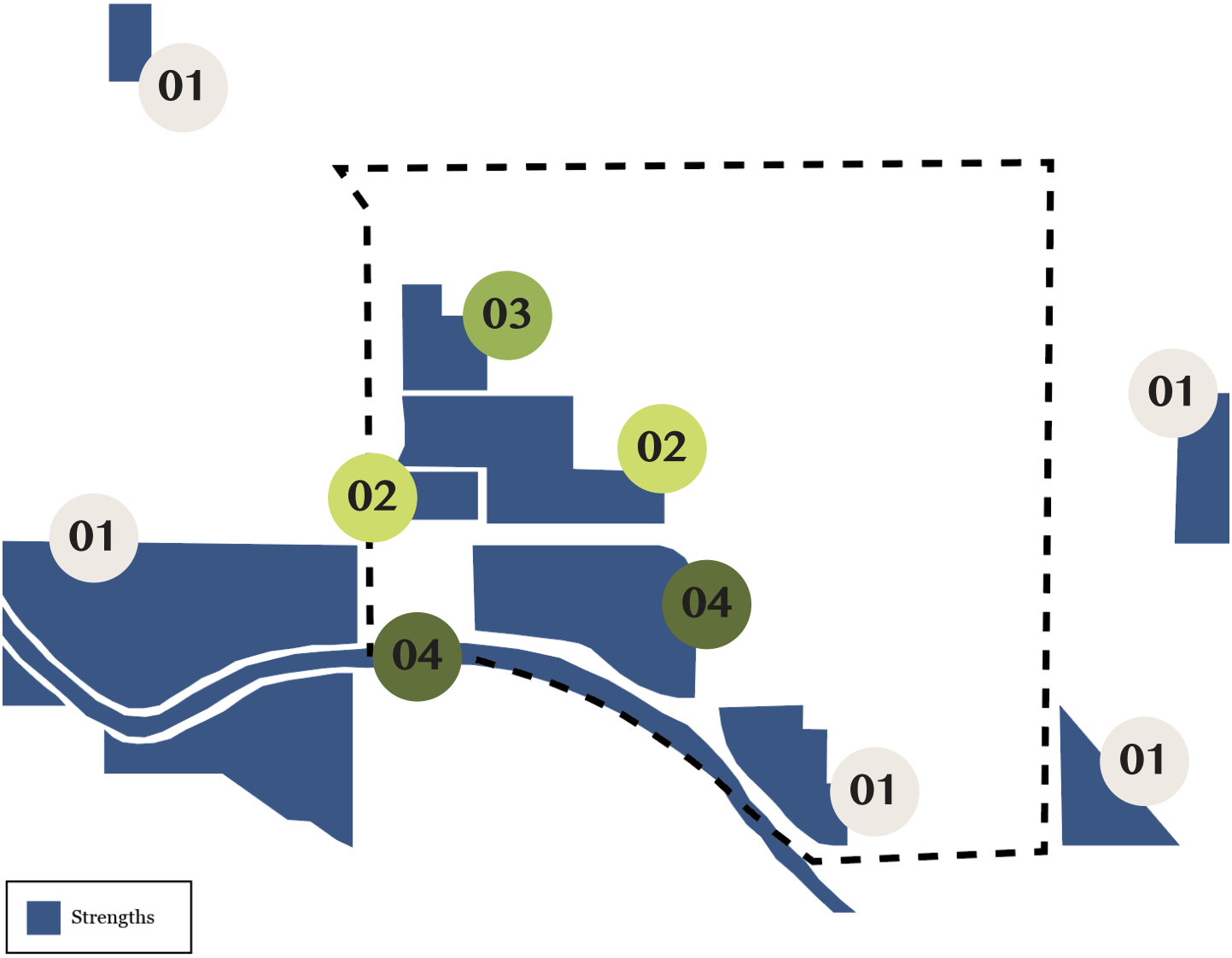
OPEN SPACE BUFFER ZONE

An analysis of the access to green space in the site showed that almost all of the residential areas are lacking immediate access.

More pocket parks and parklets will be added and connected by green alleyways.



STRENGTHS



STRENGTHS

01 NEARBY GREEN SPACES



02 EXISTING COMMERCIAL



03 PUBLIC SPACES



04 CHERRY CREEK MALL



STRENGTHS

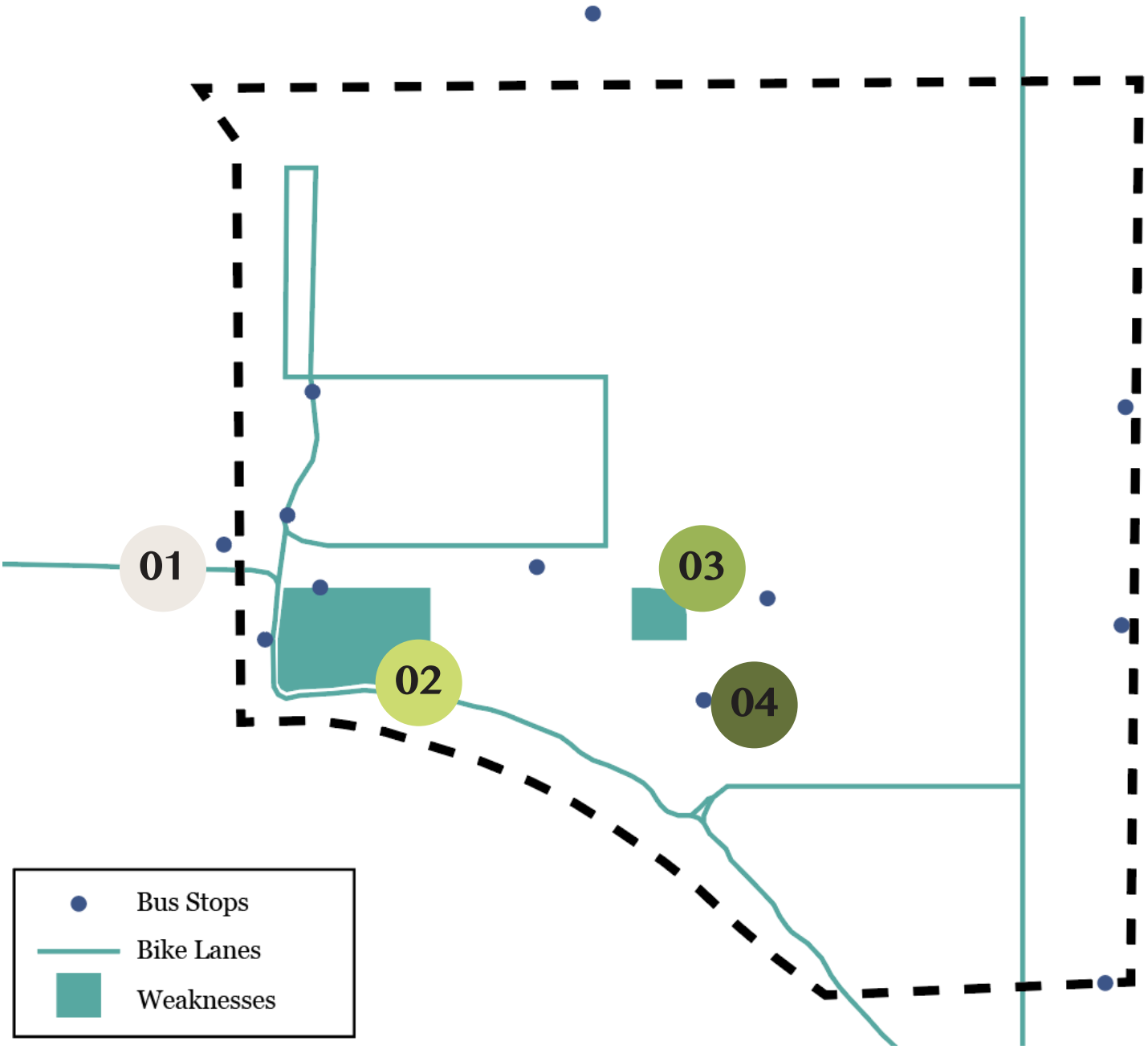
The site has extensive existing strengths both within and beyond the boundaries of the neighborhood.

There are a number of parks in the surrounding area including the green space surrounding Cherry Creek (Cherry Creek Trail), Cranmer Park, Cheesman Park, Pulaski Park, and Congress Park. However, it is visible that there is a lack of green space within the neighborhood itself.

Additional strengths within the site are primarily commercial buildings including Cherry Creek Mall, Whole Foods, and various small businesses. Another strength within the site is Bromwell Elementary School and the designated green space nearby.

We plan to build off of these strengths by connecting the existing green space with green alleyways and temporary parklets. In addition, we will revitalize the currently abandoned area of Cherry Creek Mall to further strengthen that sector of the site.

WEAKNESSES



WEAKNESSES

01 EXISTING BIKE LANES



02 ABANDONED BUILDINGS



03 EXCESS PARKING



04 EXISTING BUS STOPS



WEAKNESSES

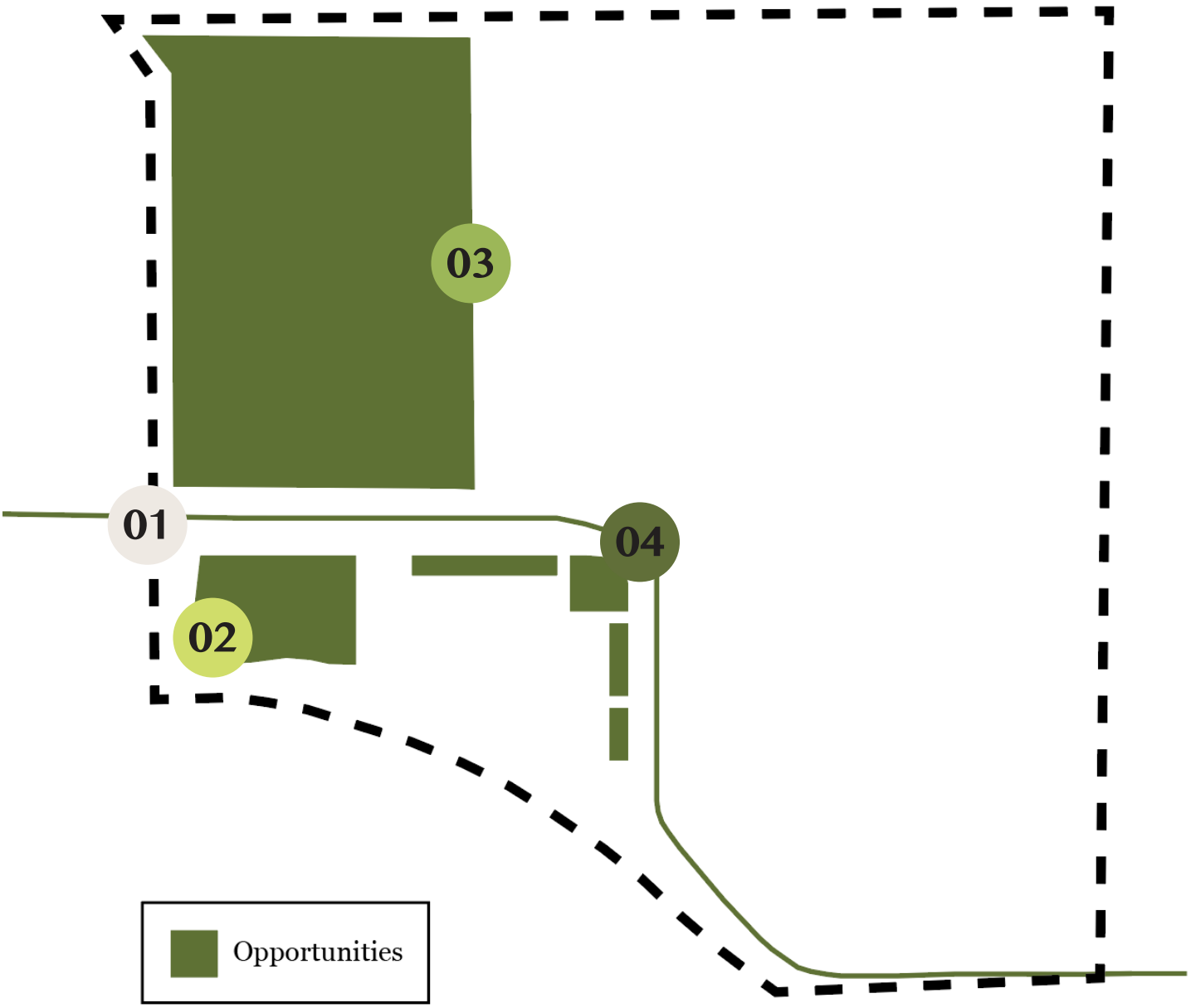
The site has a few weaknesses within the boundaries of the neighborhood. They are generally regarding accessibility to amenities, green space, and public transit.

With the public transportation around Cherry Creek only running along the borders of the neighborhood, it is difficult for people to move around without cars. In addition, it makes it harder for people to access essential amenities such as grocery stores, schools, and healthcare.

In addition to a lack of public transportation access, Cherry Creek has minimal bike lanes which further encourages the use of cars.

Surrounding Cherry Creek Mall, there is also an excess of parking and parking garages which are often unused during off-peak hours. Next to the mall, there are also three large abandoned buildings which can and should be revitalized to bring more foot traffic and tourism to the area.

OPPORTUNITIES



OPPORTUNITIES

01 ROAD DIET OPPORTUNITY



02 UNUSED BUILDINGS



03 COMMERCIAL GROWTH



04 EXCESS PARKING



OPPORTUNITIES

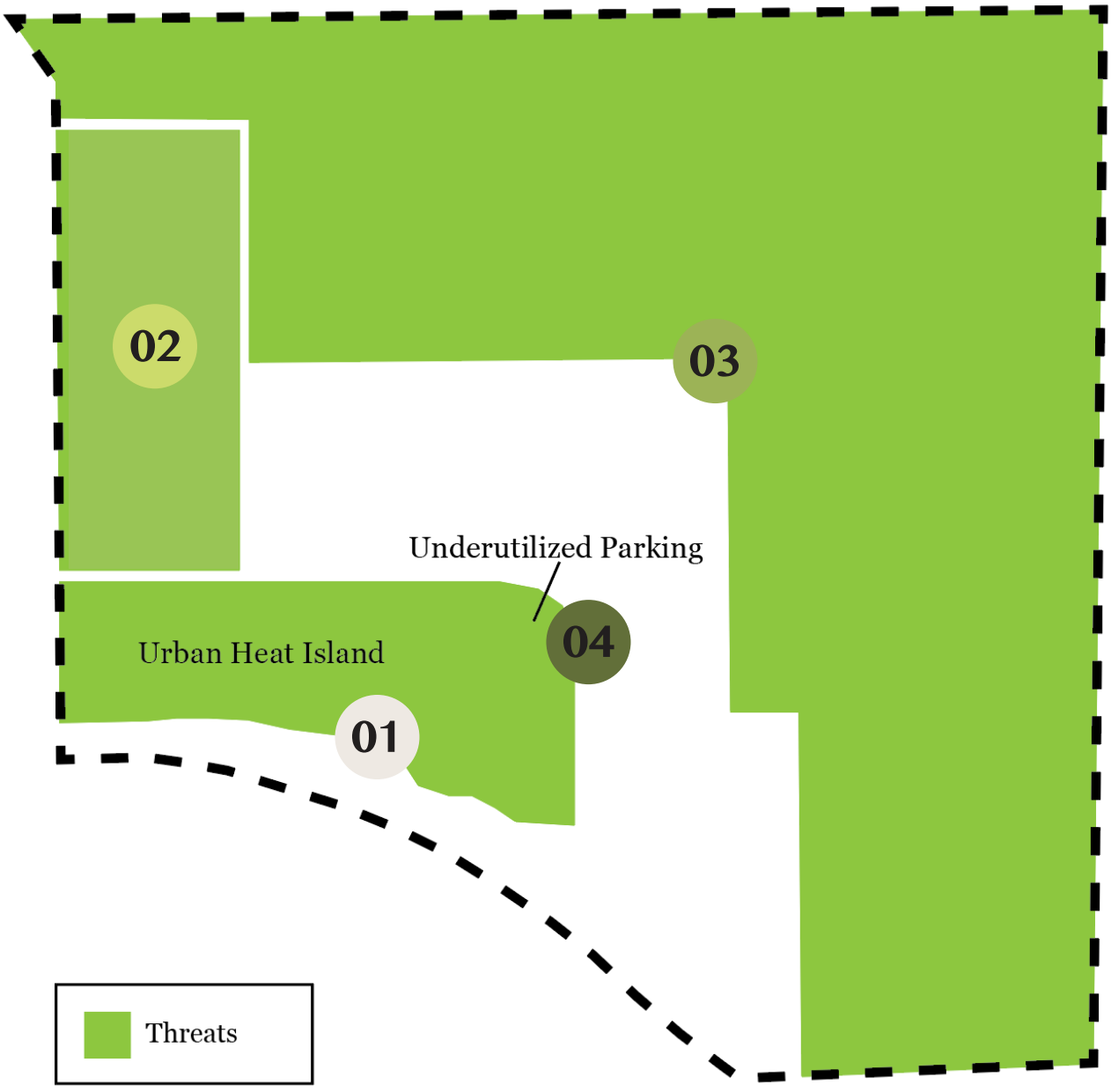
The east side of the site holds a lot of opportunity within Cherry Creek Mall and the areas north of it.

There is plenty of room for commercial expansion which will draw some of the attention from the mall to other areas of the site.

We will also be able to convert the unused parking around the mall into temporary parklets during off-peak hours. This will help enhance a sense of community in the neighborhood which aligns with our goals for the site.

In addition to converting the excess parking by the mall, we have an opportunity to implement a road diet along 1st Ave and Steele St. We plan to implement this diet through the conversion of one land into a BRT (Bus Rapid Transit) Lane during peak hours. This will bring more foot traffic into the site with more efficient public transit access while also decreasing speed and pedestrian/bicycle risk along these major roads.

THREATS


02
03
Underutilized Parking
04
Urban Heat Island
01
Threats

THREATS

01 URBAN HEAT ISLAND



02 LACK OF SMALL BUSINESSES



03 AFFORDABILITY CONCERNS



04 UNDERUTILIZED PARKING



THREATS

Existing threats in the neighborhood are largely environmental. The Cherry Creek Mall poses a massive environmental threat with urban heat island effect as a result of the dark, unused roofs and excessive parking surrounding the buildings.

The residential area poses a number of threats relating to affordability and accessibility. With minimal public transit and lack of bike lanes, residents often have no choice but to drive, further contributing to the environmental threats in the area. In terms of affordability, many of the homes are single-family while any apartments/multi-family homes are extremely expensive and newly developed. Any existing affordable housing is planned for redevelopment and will no longer be affordable for most.

Finally, the lack of small businesses and potential for them to grow on the site poses a major threat. Without small business economy, the commercial areas within the site will suffer, bringing the entire neighborhood down.

SUMMARY OF RESEARCH

EXISTING ZONING
GROWTH OPPORTUNITIES
URBAN HEAT ISLAND
EXISTING PARKING
TRAFFIC COUNTS
BICYCLE INFRASTRUCTURE

EXISTING ZONING

CURRENT ZONING

The current zoning is primarily residential ranging in density.

There is some commercial at the mall and surrounding it with some mixed-use near there as well. We can see plenty of office spaces and parking lots, but there is minimal green space across the entirety of the site.



PROPOSED ZONING

We are proposing only a few changes to the zoning as there is not a lot of room for growth with how developed the neighborhood has become.

We will be implementing some more commercial lots and converting some commercial into mixed-use, such as next to the mall.

We will also be including some more green space to connect the site.



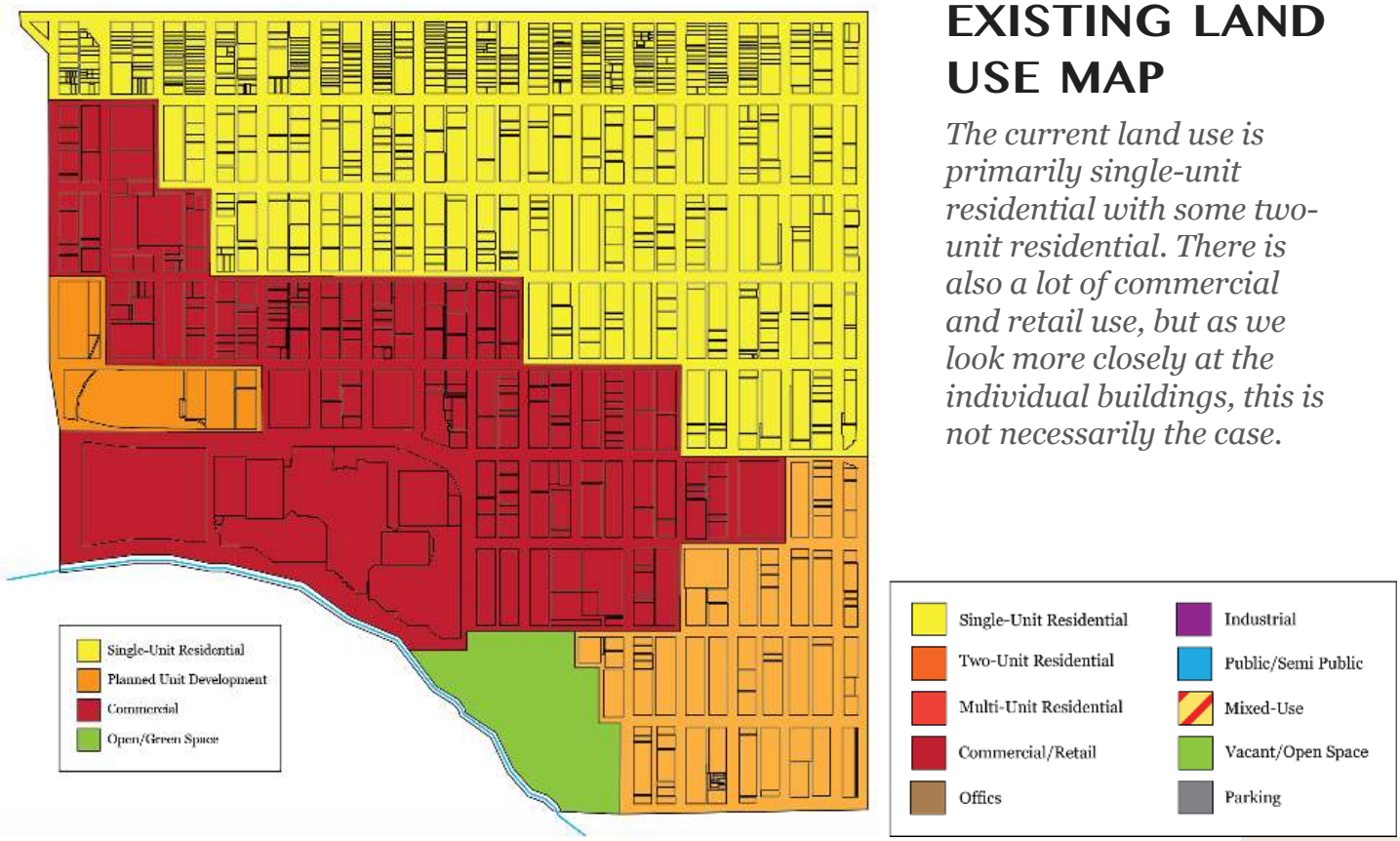
EXISTING ZONING



INTERVENTION MAP

The map shows the specific areas where we plan to redevelop or rezone.

These areas include mostly mixed-use and commercial, but we also plan to create a few pocket parks throughout the site, especially in the residential areas.



EXISTING LAND USE MAP

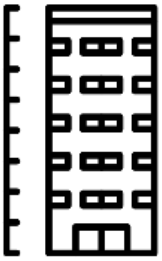
The current land use is primarily single-unit residential with some two-unit residential. There is also a lot of commercial and retail use, but as we look more closely at the individual buildings, this is not necessarily the case.

GROWTH OPPORTUNITIES

EXPANDED FLOORS BY ZONING:

124,000 SQ.FT.

With expanded floors in a number of buildings, we can create up to ~124,000 square feet of commercial and residential space.





VACANT LOTS AND EXCESS PARKING:

225,000 SQ.FT.

With maximum use of vacant lots and excess parking, we can create ~225,000 square feet of open space or room for development.





GROWTH OPPORTUNITIES



INCREASED DENSITY WITH ADUs:

122,000 SQ.FT.

With maximum density using ADUs, we can increase square footage by ~122,000 square feet. This will help with affordability by increasing density in the residential areas.





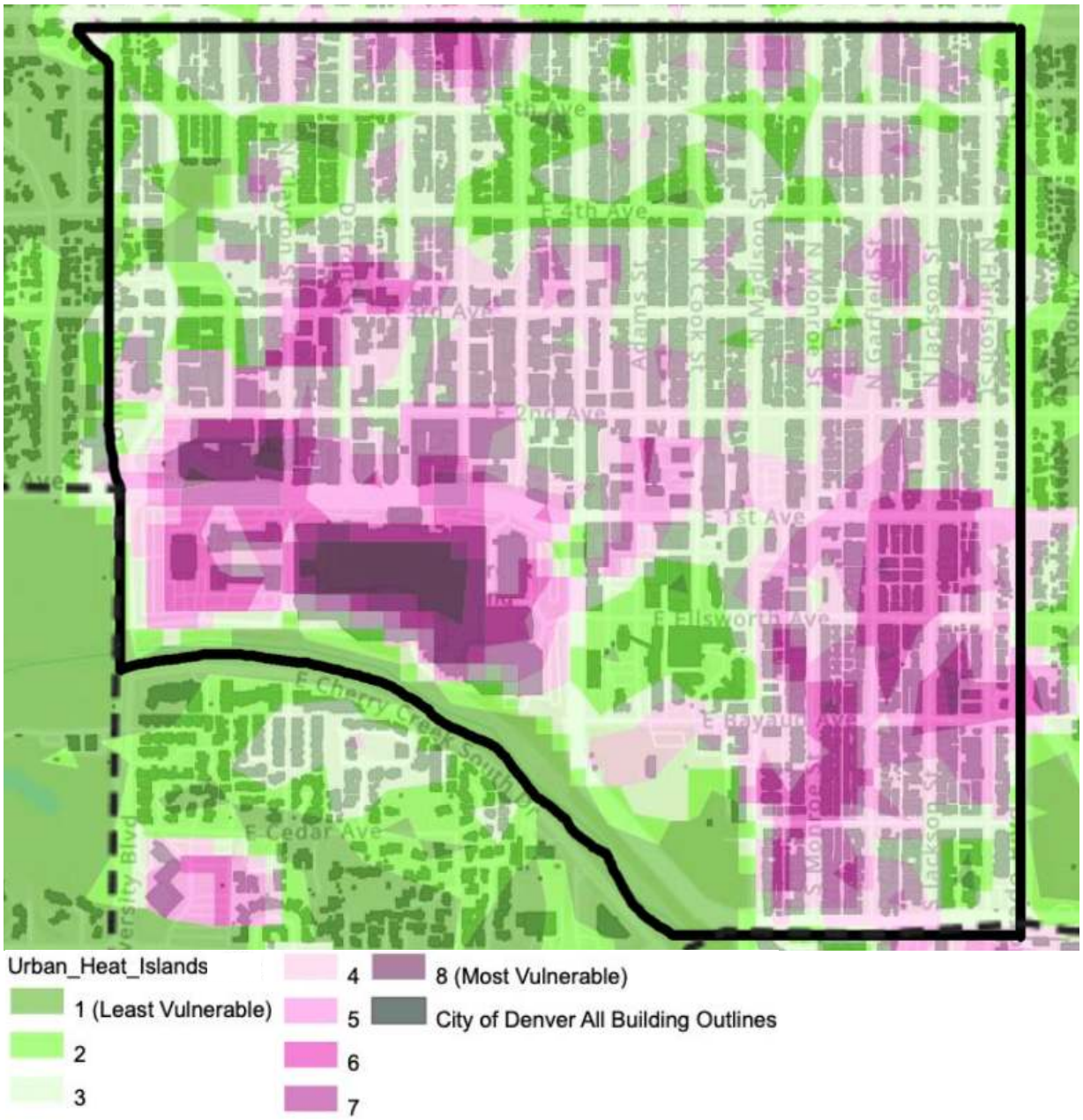
TOTAL GROWTH POTENTIAL:

471,000 SQ.FT.

If we expand all floors to the maximum heights, build on all vacant lots and reuse excess parking, while also adding ADUs throughout, we can expand 471,000 square feet.



URBAN HEAT ISLAND

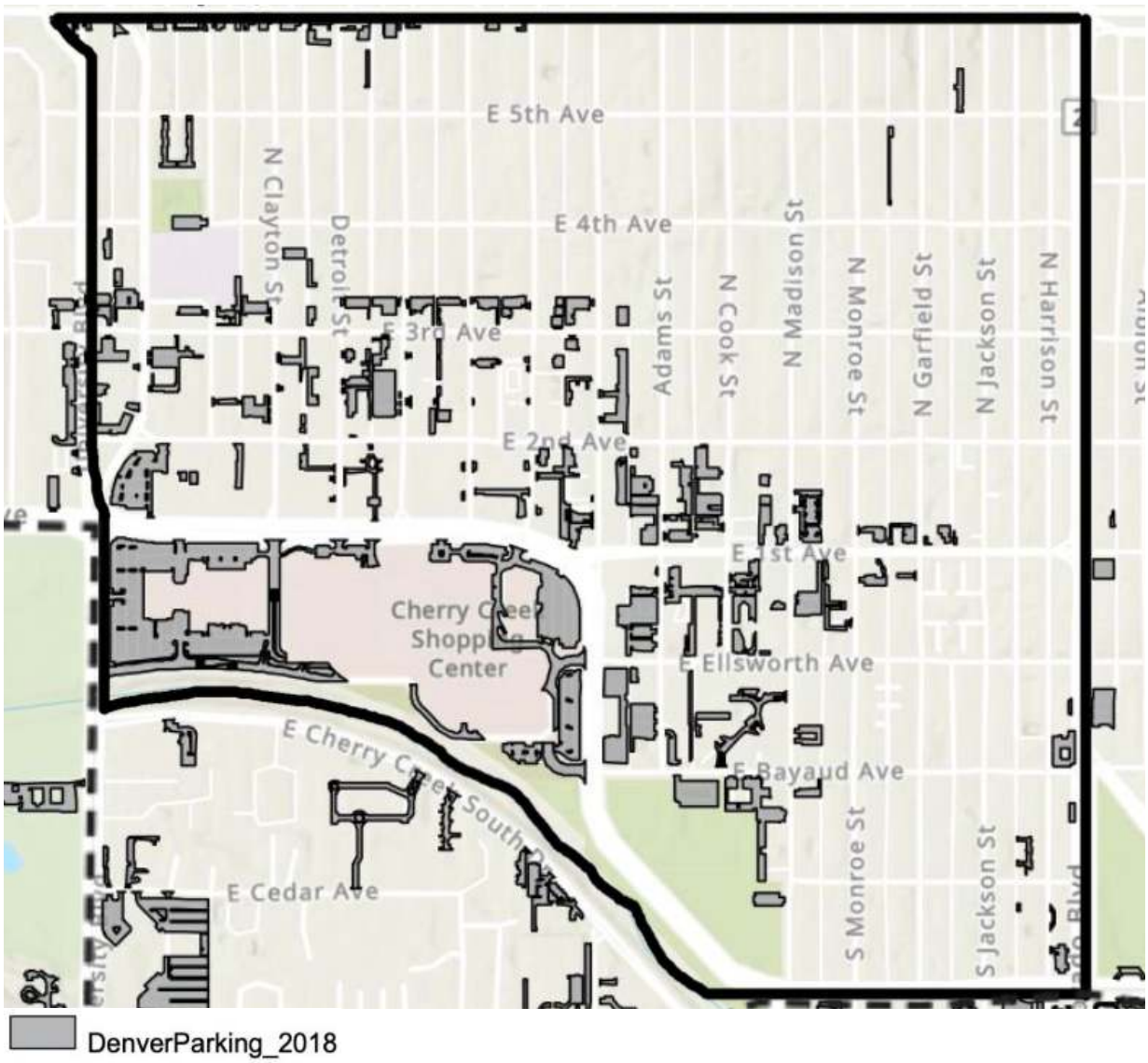


The map shows the specific areas within Cherry Creek that are most susceptible to urban heat.

The mall is extremely vulnerable due to unused roofs and parking lots.



EXISTING PARKING

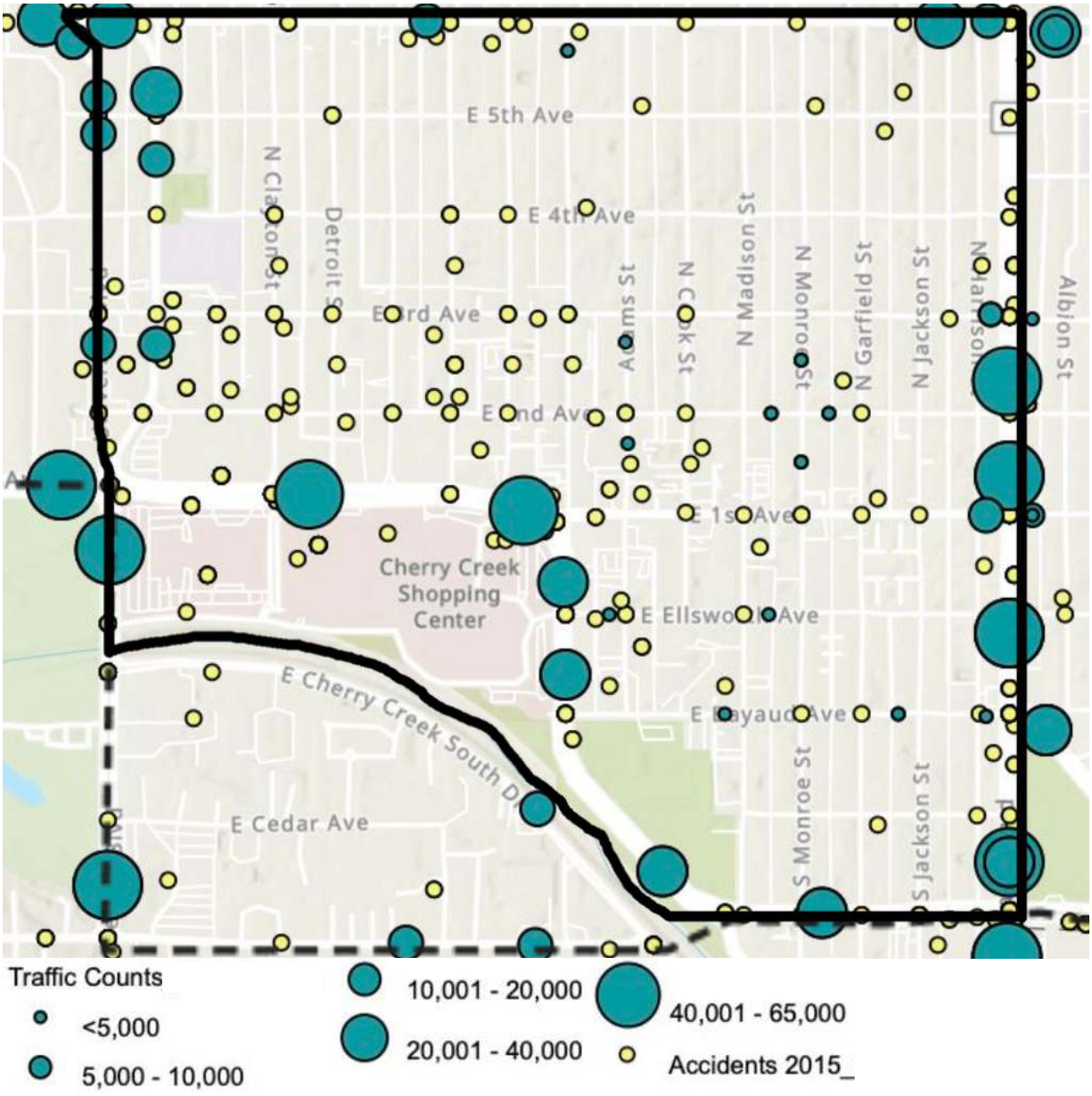




The map shows the locations of designated parking lots in Cherry Creek.

There is an excess of parking throughout the site, but especially at the mall. This also contributes heavily to urban heat.

TRAFFIC COUNTS

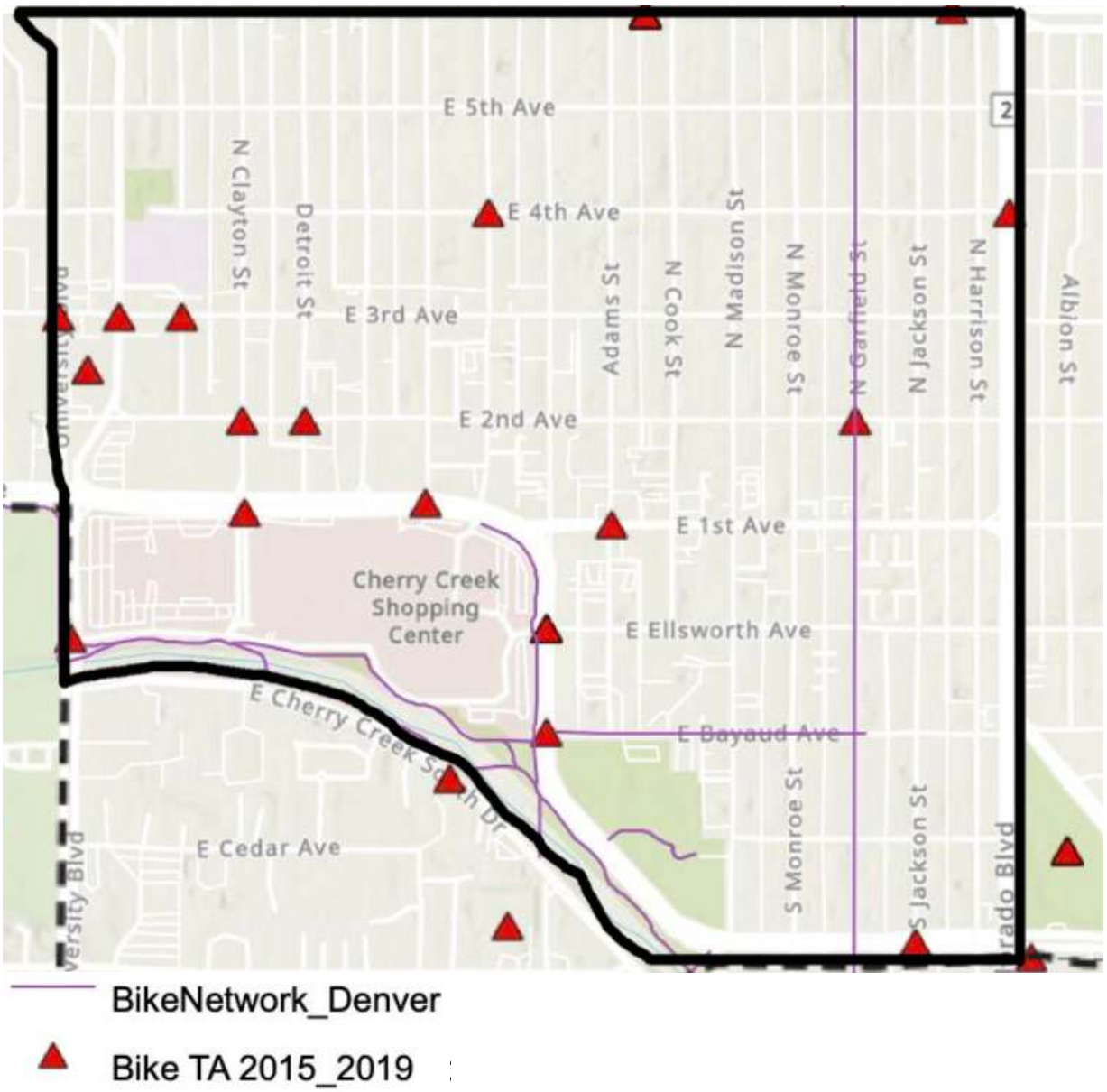


Traffic is extremely heavy on Colorado Blvd, as well as along 1st Ave/Steele St. The bordering streets are generally the most dense.

This correlates with car accident counts, but accidents are also common in the residential areas.



BICYCLE INFRASTRUCTURE





Bike accidents are distributed throughout the site but are most common along the major roads. These roads also do not have bike lanes, similar to the residential.

We are making it a priority to implement more bike lanes, especially along major roads and in the residential areas.

LEARNING BY EXAMPLE

ENVIRONMENTAL PRECEDENTS
TRANSPORTATION PRECEDENTS
CURRENT REDEVELOPMENTS

ENVIRONMENTAL PRECEDENTS

PARKROYAL COLLECTION, SINGAPORE



GREEN TERRACES

Singapore's Parkroyal Collection Hotel is a prime example of green terracing. Green terraces involve integrating vertical gardens, green roofs, and other greenery into building designs to mitigate urban heat island effects and improve air quality.

The Singapore government has actively promoted the development of green terraces and green roofs through incentives like the Skyrise Greenery Incentive Scheme.

Other examples of green terracing in Singapore include the Pan Pacific Orchard Hotel as pictured to the right.





ENVIRONMENTAL PRECEDENTS

NANYANG TECHNOLOGICAL UNIVERSITY, SINGAPORE







GREEN ROOFS

Green roofs in combination with green terraces are a primary strategy in Singapore's plan to move away from the garden city model and towards a "city in a garden" model.

Green roofs help us combat urban heat, manage storm water, improving air quality, increasing diversity, and enhancing aesthetics overall.

Another examples of green roofs in Singapore is the Oasia Hotel. It is a spectacular architectural innovation made of green walls and roofs. The walls are covered in red aluminum mesh which can house up to 21 species of creeping plants and vines.

MICRO-MOBILITY HUBS IN NEW YORK CITY

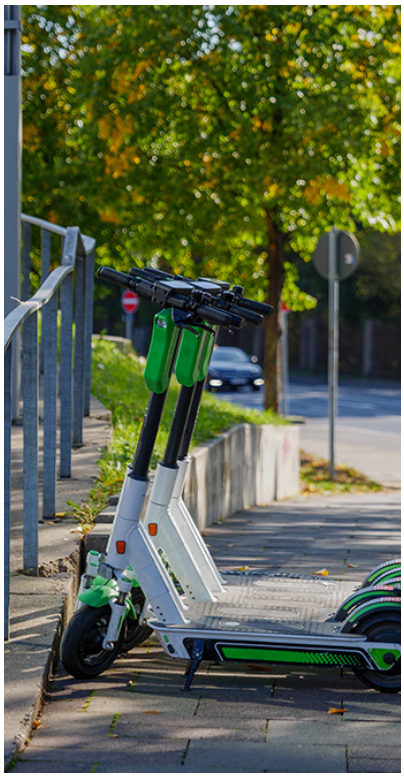


MICRO-MOBILITY HUBS

New York, New York has developed an extensive network of micro-mobility hubs.

They have implemented on-street and off-street micro hub zones, encouraged sustainable delivery methods, and promote safe e-bike charging and storage.

Their "Charge Safe, Ride Safe" incentive also aims to address the increase in fires and fatalities related to improper storage and charging of e-micro-mobility devices, promoting safe and legal e-micro-mobility use.





TRANSPORTATION PRECEDENTS

BRT LANES IN BOGOTA, COLOMBIA







BRT LANES

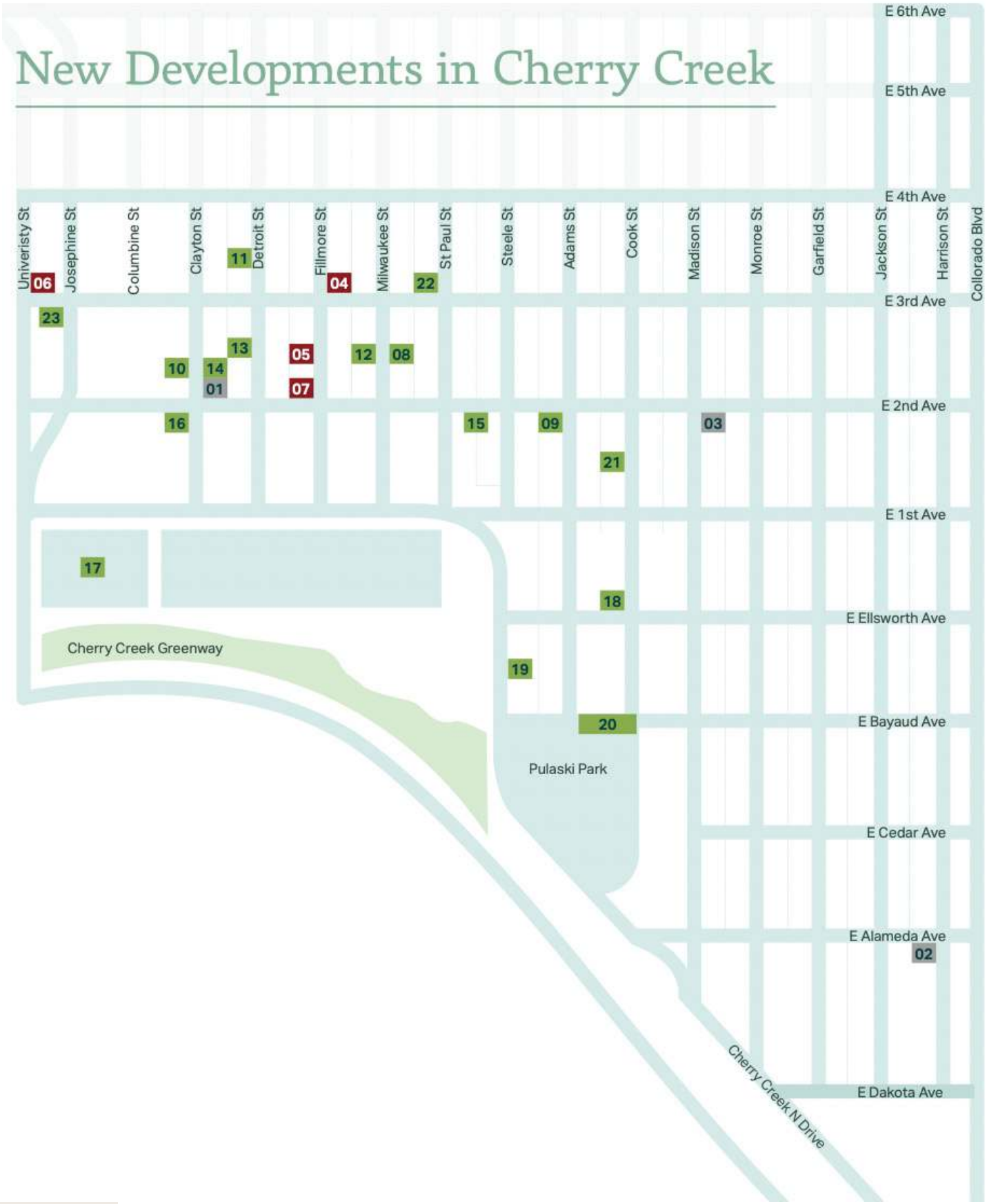
Bogotá, Colombia is renowned for its Bus Rapid Transit (BRT) system, known as TransMilenio.

The system uses dedicated BRT lanes that allow buses to bypass regular traffic, significantly reducing travel times across the city.

These lanes are crucial to Bogotá's public transit strategy, helping to accelerate travel for everyone.

Although it has been successful, some question what future expansion and modernization will look like as overcrowding becomes a major issue.

CURRENT REDEVELOPMENTS



CURRENT REDEVELOPMENTS

Between 2020 and the end of 2023, four new office projects added 243,000 sq. ft. of office space.

In 2024-2025, retailers and businesses anticipate the completion of four exciting new commercial buildings, which will add an additional 360,000 sq. ft. of office space to the area. The largest of these projects, a 140,500 sq. ft. eight-story office building located at 2nd ad Fillmore, will offer five levels of parking.

In the greater Cherry Creek area, building permit revenue increased 72.6% to a total of $458,000.

Permits issues for new buildings in 2023 were valued at $49.3 million, a 27.5% increase over 2022.

	Project Name	Address	Use	Description	Completed
08	242 Milwaukee	240, 242, 244 Milwaukee St	Office/Retail	90,000 SF Office / 10,000 SF Retail	2025
09	3250 East 2nd Ave	3250 E 2nd Ave	Office/Retail	5 stories, 90,000 SF Office & Retail	2025
10	Cherry Cricket Office Development	2645 E. 2nd Ave	Office/Retail	8 stories, 97,000 SF Class A Office	2025
11	329 Detroit	329 Detroit St	Residential/Retail	9 Condo, 3 Retail, 2 Office Spaces	2026
12	299 Milwaukee St	231,233,299 Milwaukee	Residential/Retail	156 Luxury / 30,000 SF Retail	2026
13	210 Detroit	219,231,239, 255 Detroit St	Residential/Retail	88 Apartment Homes with Retail on Ground Floor	2027
14	250 Clayton	250 Clayton St	Office	215,000 SF Office	TBD
15	185 Steele	185 Steele St, 162 & 190 Saint Paul St	Residential/Retail	38 Condo Homes	TBD
16	Clayton Lane	E 1st Ave & Josephine St	Retail/Residential	TBD	TBD
17	Cherry Creek West	SW Corner of S University Blvd & E 1st Ave	Office/Retail/ Residential	TBD	TBD
18	5 Cook Street	S Cook St	Residential/Retail	TBD	TBD
19	50 South Steele	50 S Steele St	Residential/Retail	TBD	TBD
20	Bayaud & Madison	3400 E Bayaud Ave & 121 S Madison St	Residential/Retail	TBD	TBD
21	Modera Cook Street	155 & 16S N Cook St	Residential	110 Apartment Homes	TBD
22	3035 East 3rd Ave.	3035 E 3rd Avenue	Office/Retail	3 floors of Office Space, 47,000 SF	TBD
23	210 University	210 University	Office/Retail	4 stories of Office/Retail	TBD

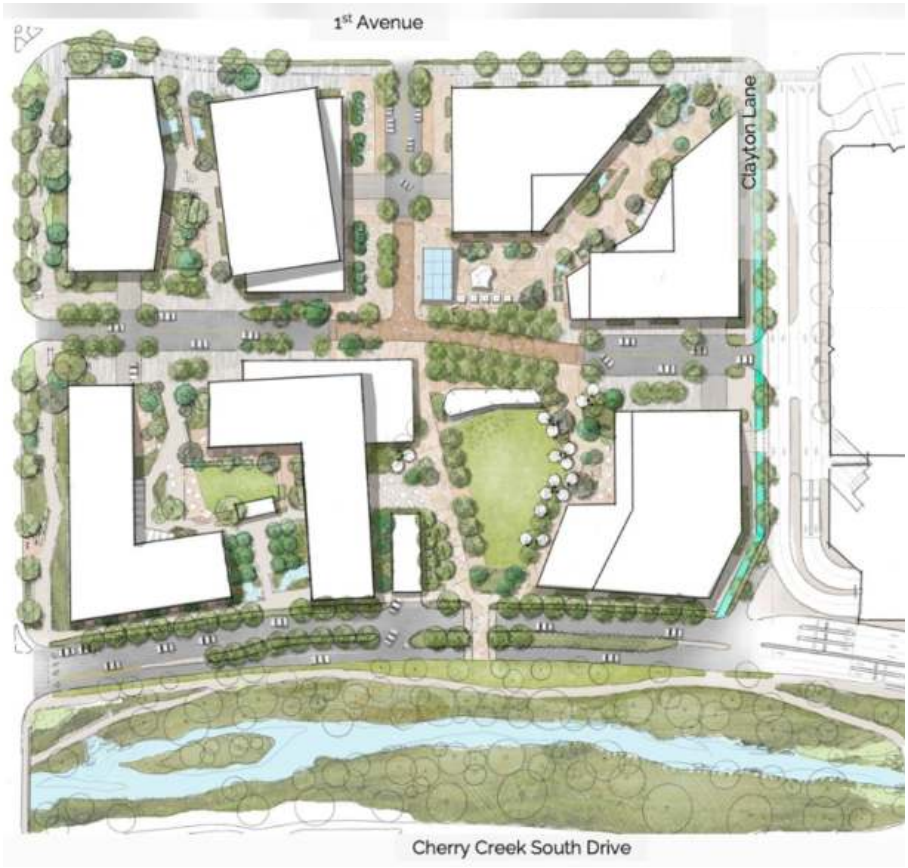
CURRENT REDEVELOPMENTS

CHERRY CREEK WEST

A 15-minute community model focused on combining living, working, and gathering spaces into one mixed-use development.

A planned 4 city blocks, 7 buildings, and 3.8 acres of open space, all within 15 minutes.

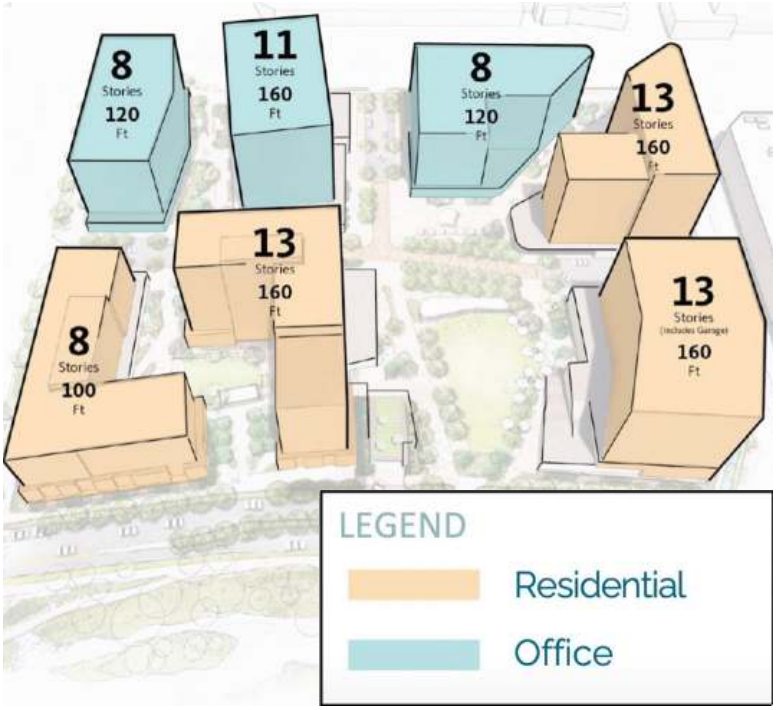


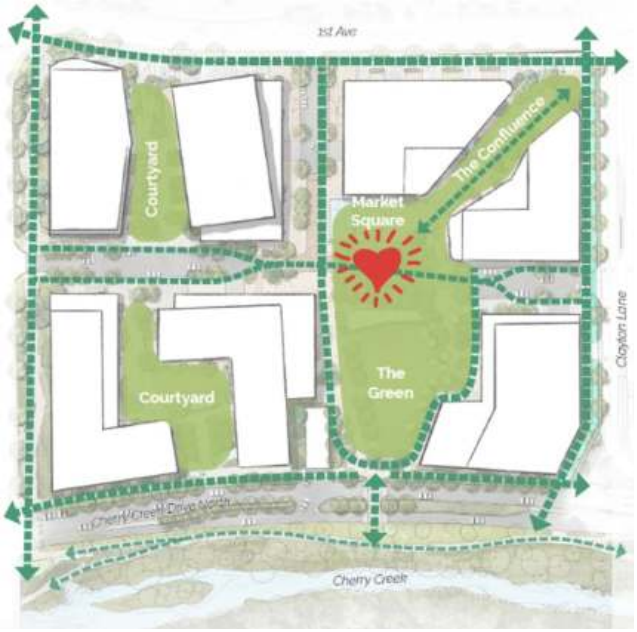




CURRENT REDEVELOPMENTS

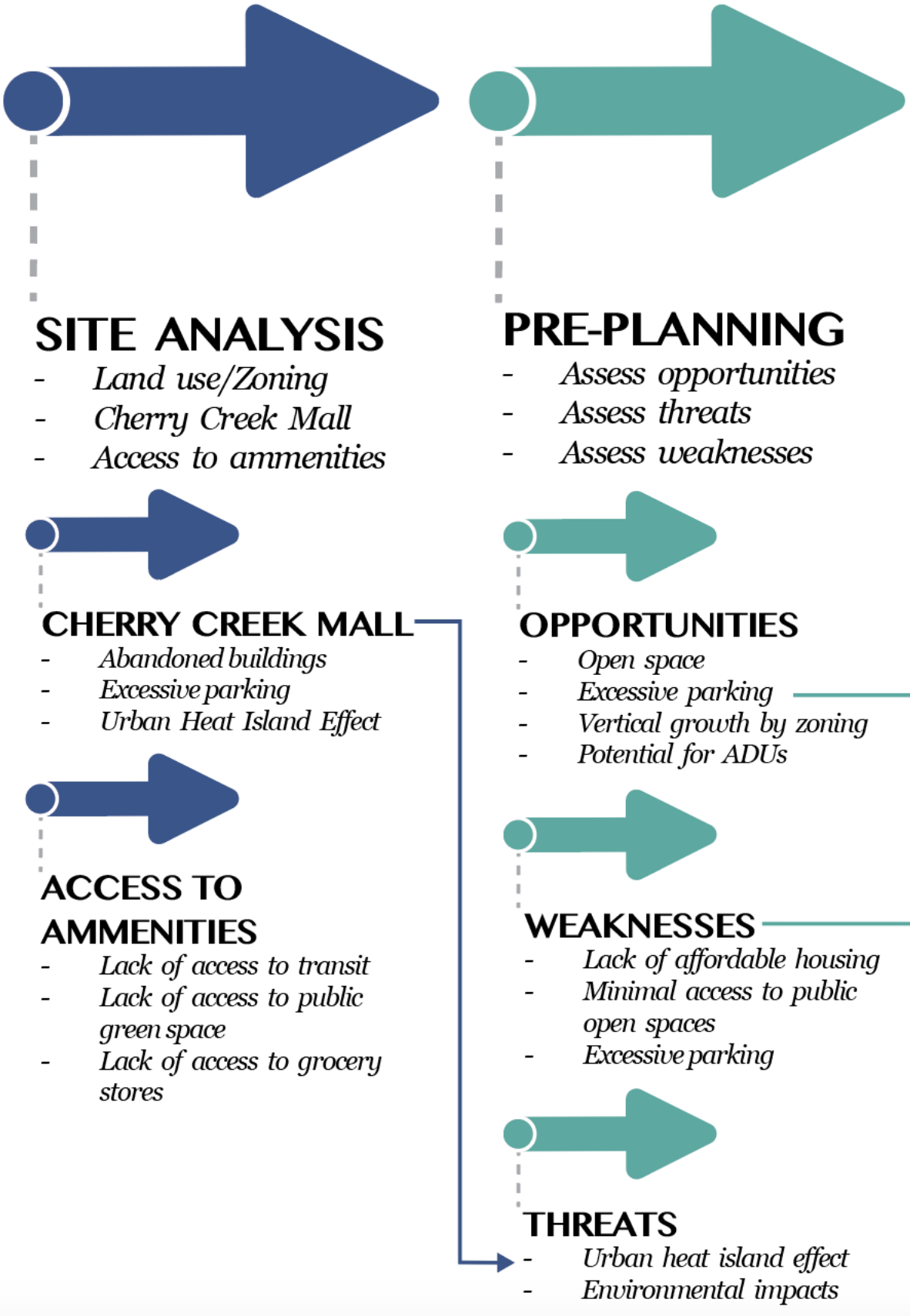






DESIGN PROCESS

DECISION-MAKING PROCESS
FLOWERS OF OPPORTUNITY
CONCEPTUAL DESIGN


SITE ANALYSIS
- Land use/Zoning
- Cherry Creek Mall
- Access to ammenities
PRE-PLANNING
- Assess opportunities
- Assess threats
- Assess weaknesses
CHERRY CREEK MALL
- Abandoned buildings
- Excessive parking
- Urban Heat Island Effect
OPPORTUNITIES
- Open space
- Excessive parking
- Vertical growth by zoning
- Potential for ADUs
ACCESS TO AMMENITIES
- Lack of access to transit
- Lack of access to public green space
- Lack of access to grocery stores
WEAKNESSES
- Lack of affordable housing
- Minimal access to public open spaces
- Excessive parking
THREATS
- Urban heat island effect
- Environmental impacts

DECISION-MAKING PROCESS

CONCEPTUAL DESIGN

- *Zoning*
- *Urban Heat Island*

URBAN HEAT ISLAND

- *Green roofs*
- *Solar panels*
- *Increase open space*
- *Convert underutilized parking*

ZONING

- *Blend residential and commercial*
- *Distribute commercial*

DETAILED DESIGN

- *Convert and connect open spaces*
- *Increase accessibility*

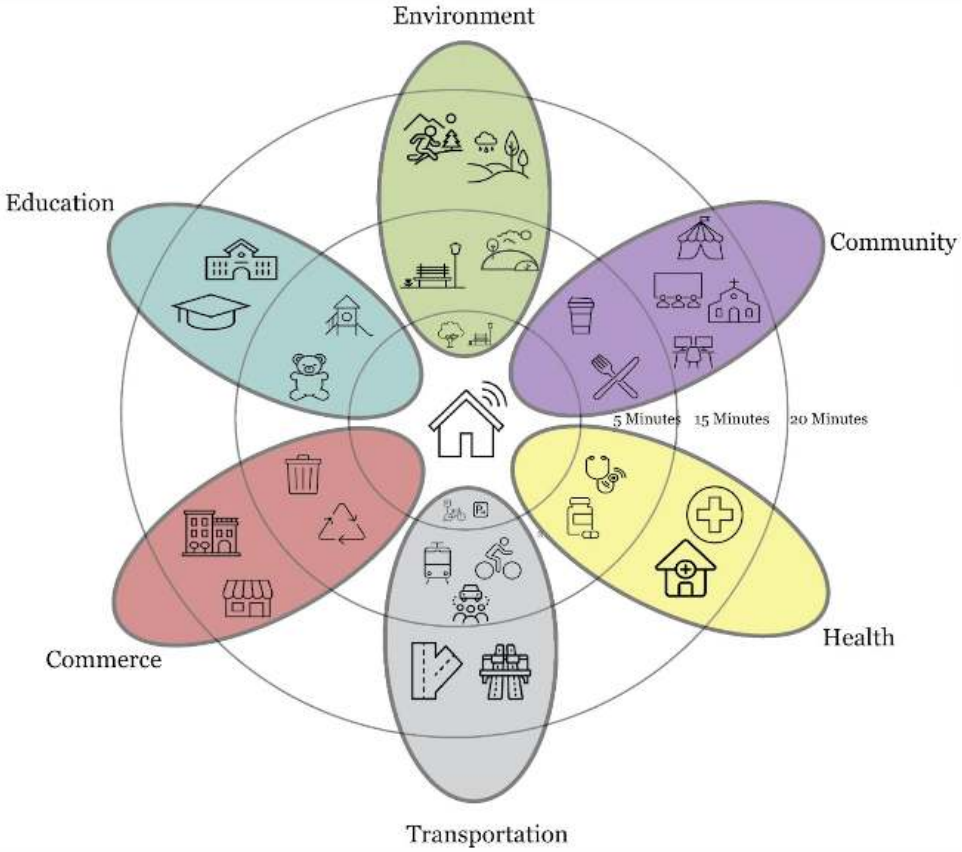
CONVERT AND CONNECT

- *Convert underutilized parking into public parklets*
- *Convert extra parking by Cherry Creek Mall into an expanded park along Cherry Creek Trail*
- *Connect green space with green alleyways*

INCREASE ACCESSIBILITY

- *Pedestrianization*
- *Improving bicycle infrastructure with increased and protected bike lanes*

FLOWERS OF OPPORTUNITY



FLOWER OF OPPORTUNITY

Cherry Creek Connect aims to increase access to open space, parks, primary schools, waste services, public transportation, bike shares, healthcare, coffee shops, and restaurants within a ten minute walk. Within a 15 minute walk, we will increase access to recreation spaces, high schools and universities, commercial activities, arterial roads, hospitals, and larger communal spaces.



FLOWER OF OPPORTUNITY

This flower of opportunity shows us where the 5, 10, and 15 minute walking buffer exists around the residential area.

We can use this information to understand what resources and ammenities people need access to and within what distance.

There are a number of opportunities to expand commercial access and access to basic ammenities like grocery stores.

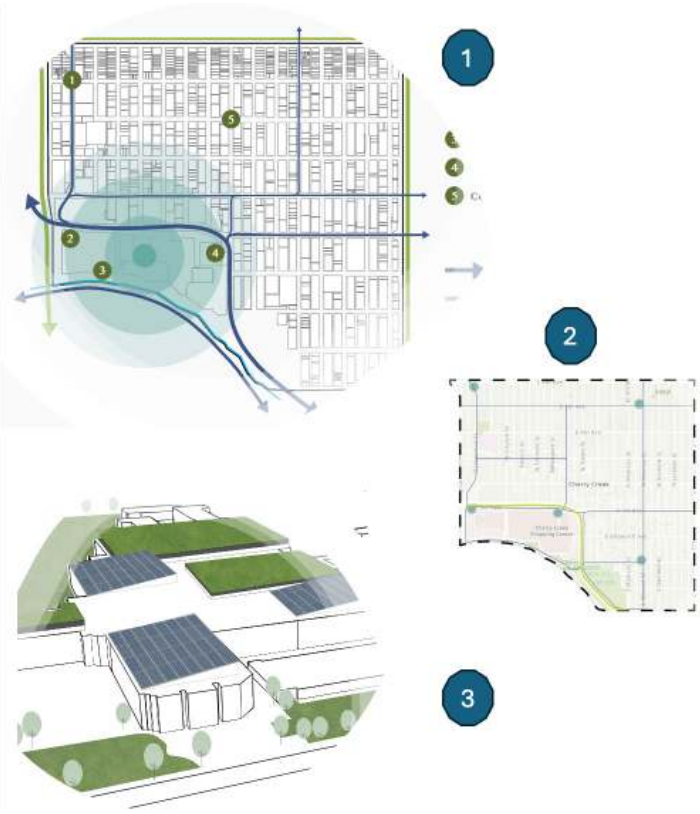


CONCEPTUAL DESIGN

Cherry Creek Connect aims to expand existing commercial areas near Cherry Creek Shopping Mall, repurpose abandoned buildings, expand and connect green space, convert unused/excess parking, and increase connectivity with pedestrian alleyways.

New and enhanced bike lanes and sidewalks will promote active mobility. Additional restaurants and public amenities will draw more tourism and increase night life in the expanded commercial areas.

Neighborhood community areas will promote social interaction between local residents and even tourists.



1. Community Engagement and Feedback

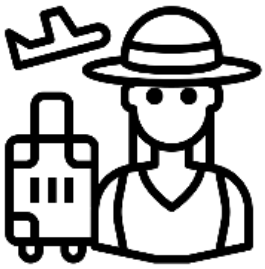
- *Gather public input on recommendations*
- *Examine potential before vs. after based on comments*

2. BRT and Bike Lane Implementation

- *Review land structure to accommodate multimodal transit*
- *Paint bike sharrows on lower-volume streets, lane markings on higher-volume streets*

3. Buildng Treatment and Revitalization

- *Install solar panels and roof gardens*
- *Use incentives to motivate residents to finance treatments*

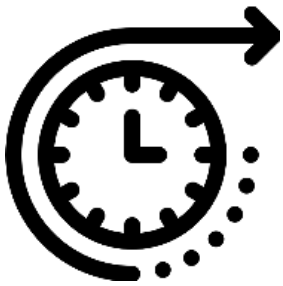


VISITOR / TOURIST

"Cherry Creek in Denver really has it all! Everything is so close, and with the vast amount of and public transportation, getting to local attractions like the Botanical Gardens and the Zoo is a breeze."

FUTURE RESIDENT

"I'm so excited to live in an area where everything I need is just around the corner, from Whole Foods and Nordstrom to charming local boutiques. It's so convenient!"





CURRENT RESIDENT

"I'm really enjoying the changes in Cherry Creek, especially since I live in the northern area. It used to be that there was nothing within walking distance, but now we have local spots and shops nearby. It's so nice having more options nearby!"

COMMUTER RESIDENT

"The new bus stations and transportation options have made my commute so much easier. I have more choices now, whether I decide to take the bus or drive. On the days I do drive, the roads are much less congested, thanks to more people using public transportation and biking."

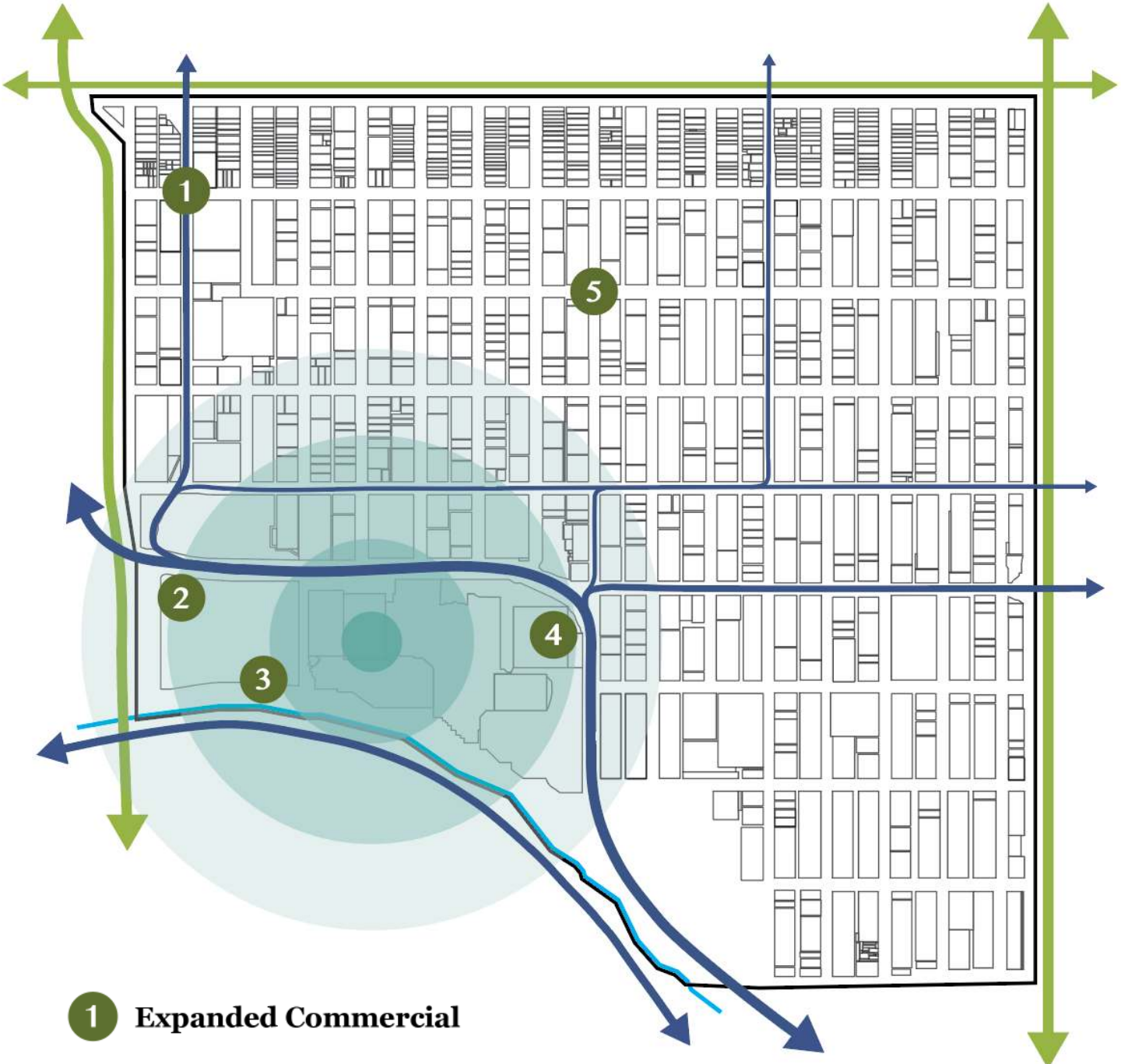




EMPLOYEE COMMUTER

"Since the changes in Cherry Creek, getting to the mall has been so much easier and more enjoyable. I work double shifts at Macy's, and now I can step outside during breaks to enjoy the new spaces right outside the mall. It's made a huge difference! I feel more connected to nature and the community now."

CONCEPTUAL DESIGN



1 Expanded Commercial

2 Repurposed Buildings

3 Expanded Green Space

4 Converted Parking

5 Connective Alleyways

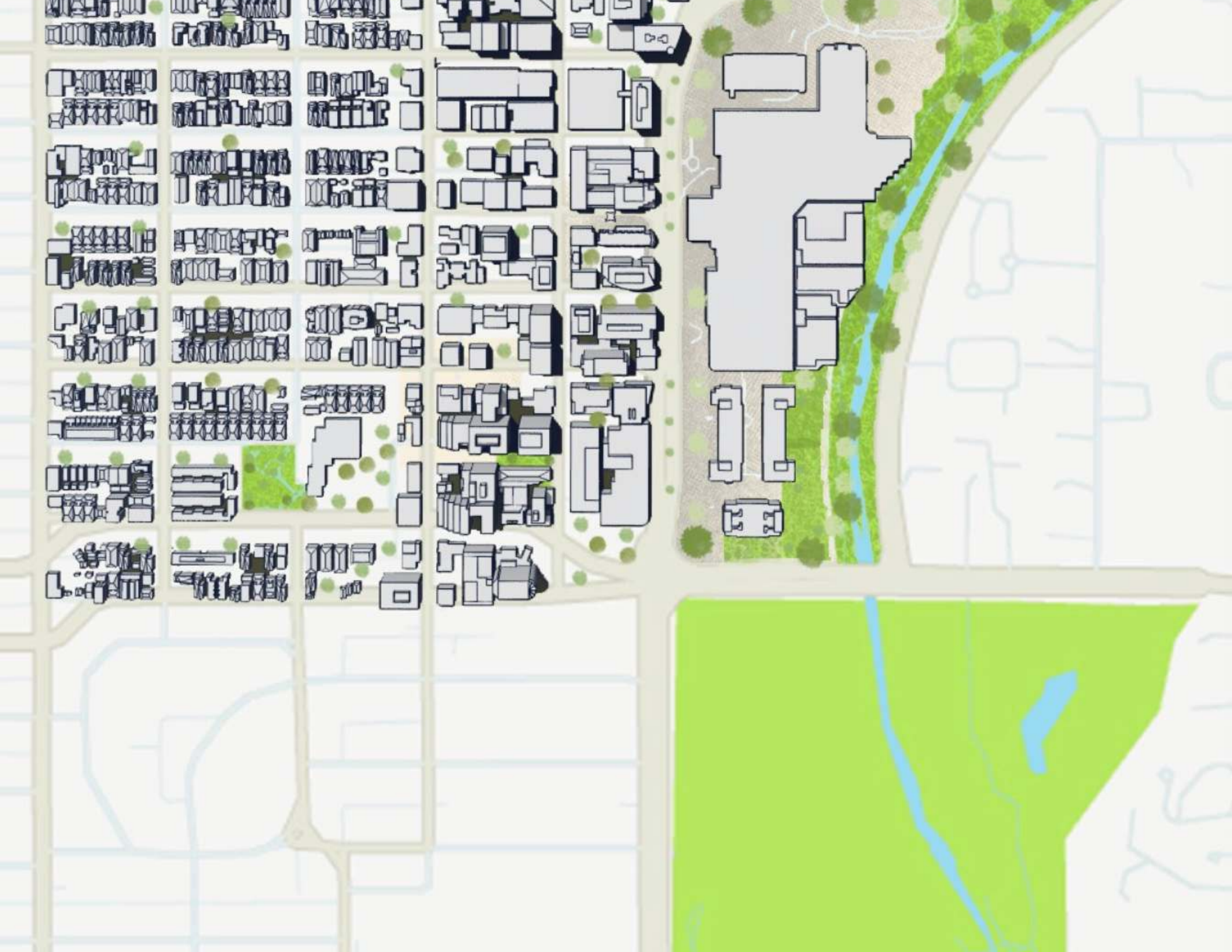
Proposed Circulation

Existing Circulation

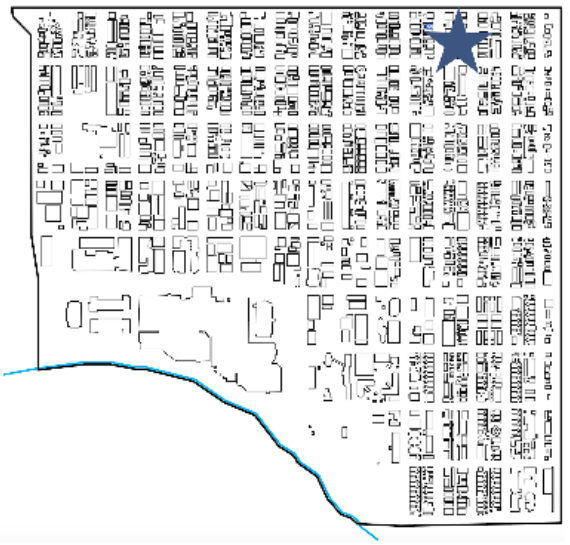
Impact of Primary Intervention

DESIGN PROPOSAL

RESIDENTIAL STREETS
COMMERCIAL STREETS
CHERRY CREEK MALL PROPOSAL
COMMERCIAL EXPANSION
MIXED-USE EXPANSION
CONNECTIVITY INTERVENTIONS
ROOF INTERVENTIONS
STORMWATER MANAGEMENT

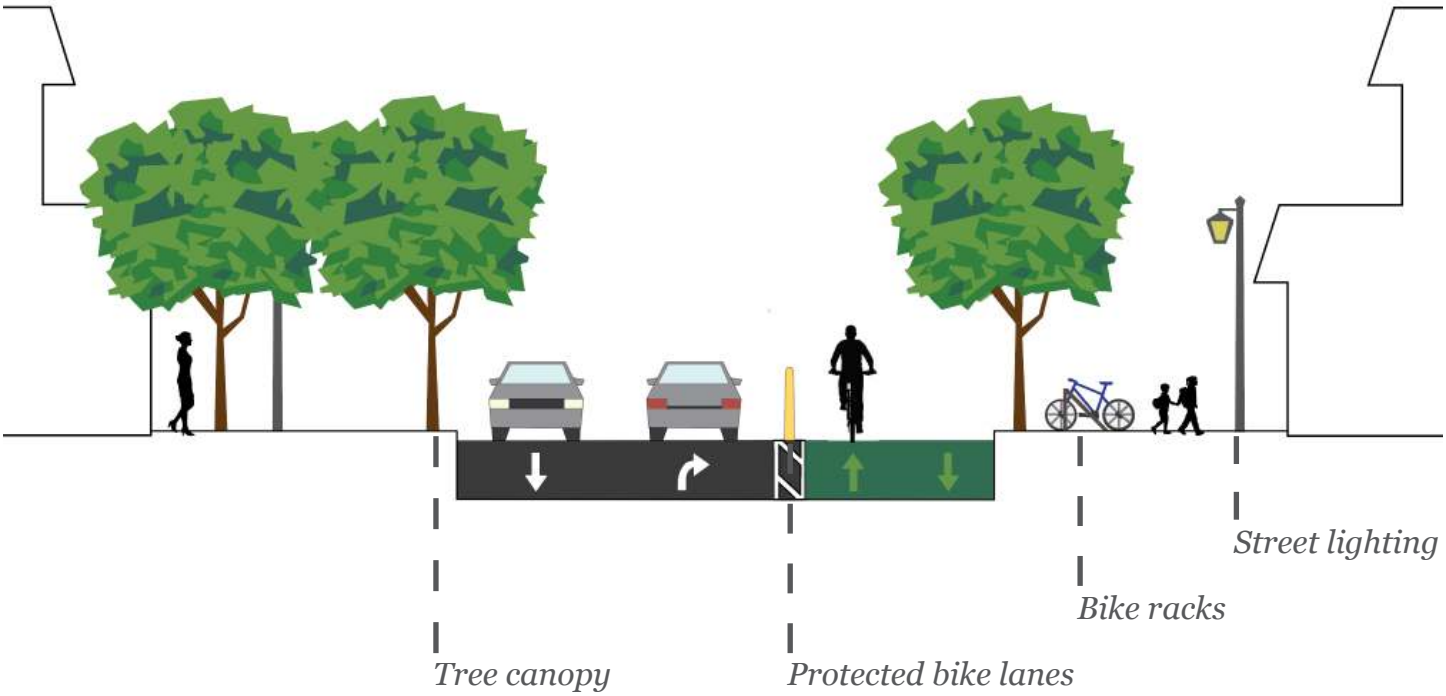






MONROE ST AND GARFIELD ST

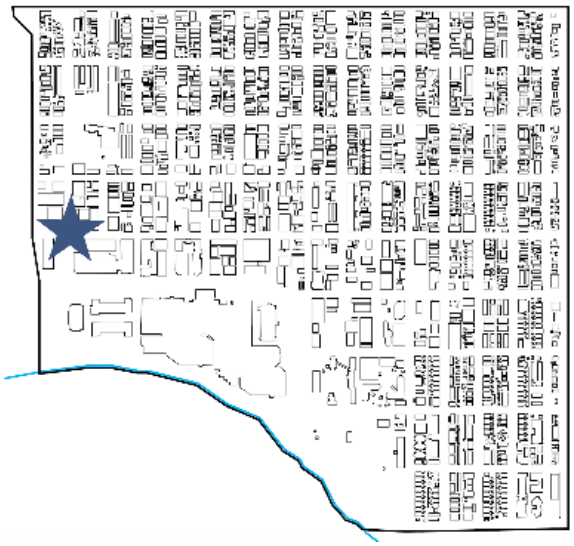
Majority single-family housing



Residential streets in Cherry Creek are often primarily made up of single family housing. Many of these roads currently lack bike lanes which prevents residents from using active mobility (walking or biking).

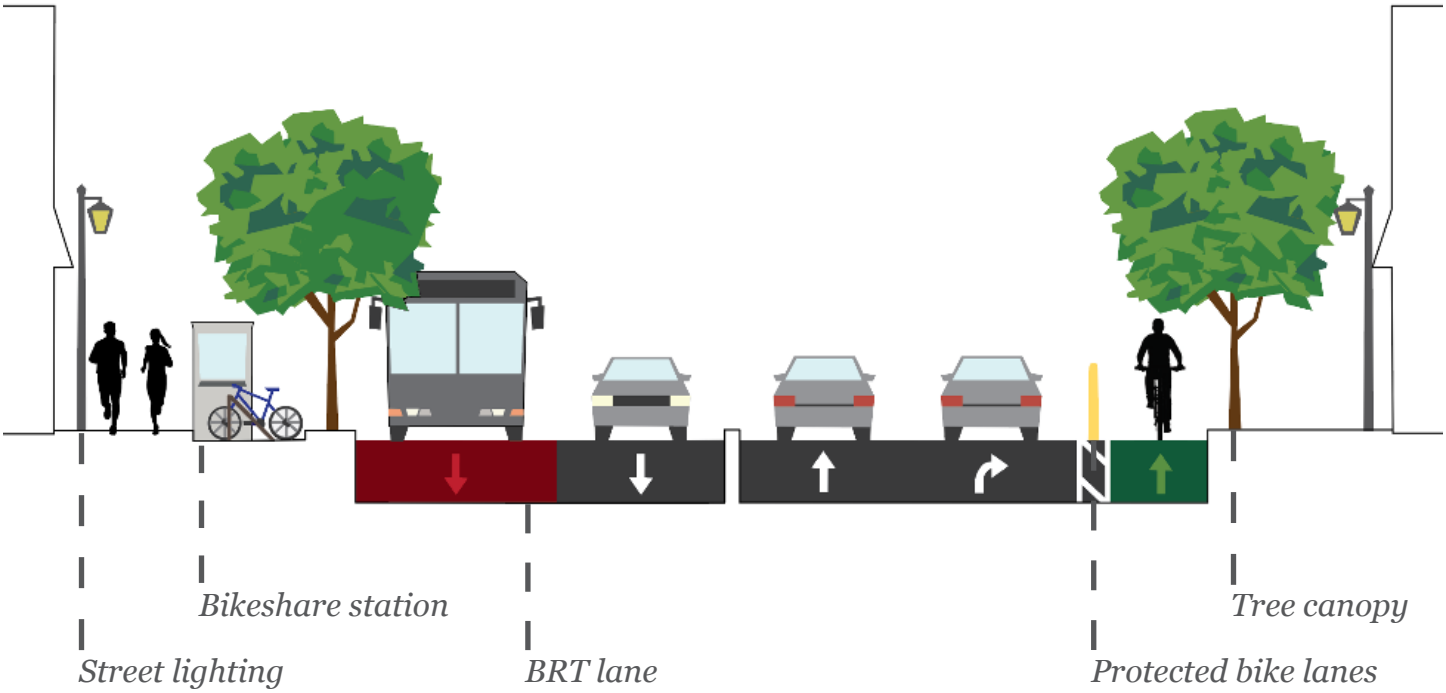
Cherry Creek Connect proposes increased protected bike lanes, especially in residential areas. Bike racks spread across the length of the bike lane further motivate residents to bike instead of drive.

In addition, tree canopy will be improved along residential streets. This will improve overall aesthetic of the neighborhood, address urban heat, and encourage residents to spend more time outside with more accessible shade. Street lighting will also be improved on residential streets for safety.



3RD AVE AND JOSEPHINE ST

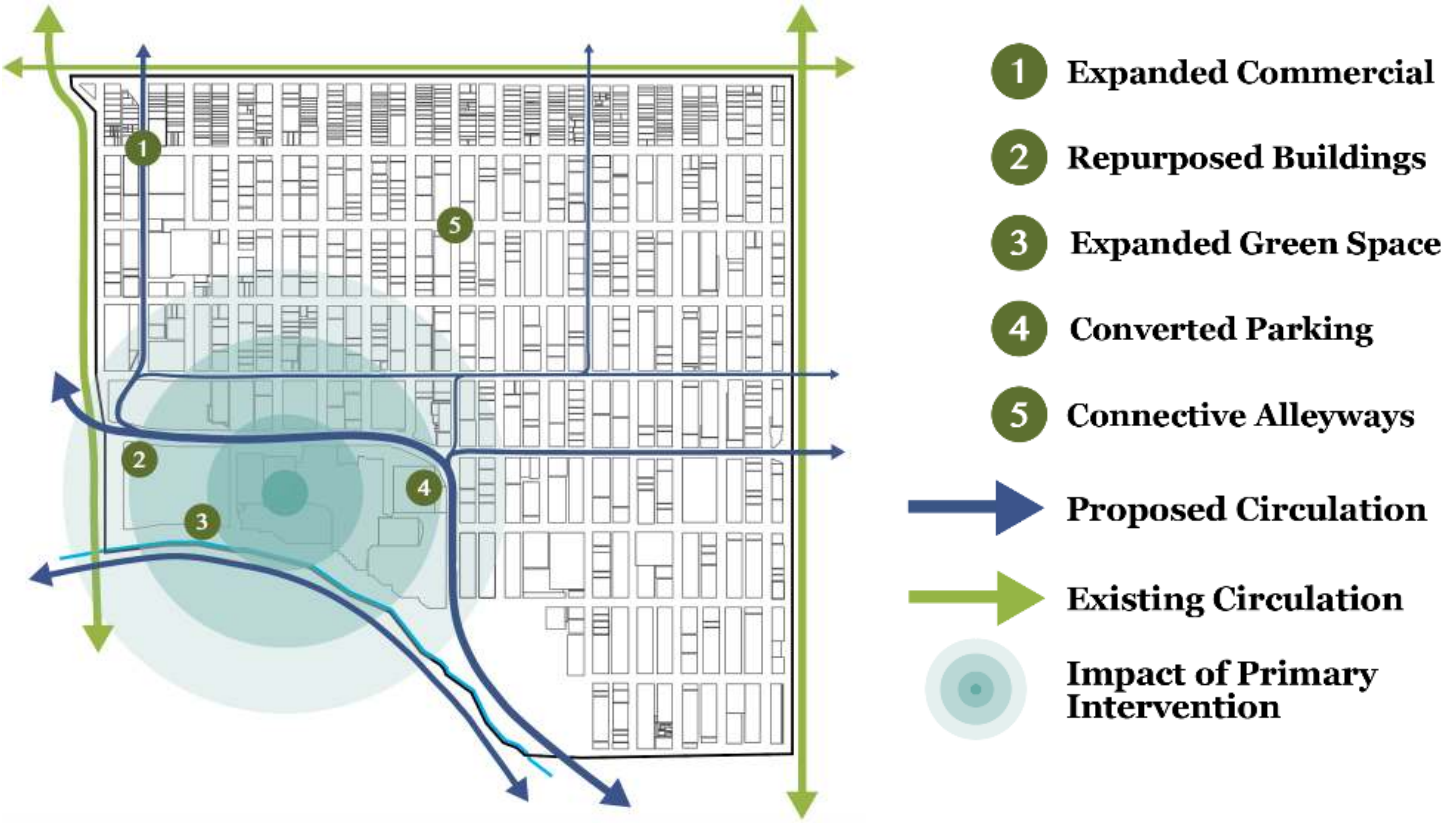
Commercial and mixed-use strip



The intersection at 3rd Ave and Josephine St is is very busy. These are two commercial streets that intersect near Cherry Creek Shopping Center. The intersection can get very busy and does not have an existing bike lane which makes it unsafe.

Cherry Creek Connect proposes an additional protected bike line to motivate residents to use sustainable transit. BRT lanes will also be implemented during peak hours to increase bike safety and increase efficiency of public transportation. This type of road diet also decreases the speed of regular traffic in other lanes, making the roads safer for drivers, bikers, and pedestrians.

CHERRY CREEK MALL PROPOSAL



REVITALIZING CHERRY CREEK MALL

Cherry Creek Mall currently has three abandoned buildings, as highlighted in the neighborhood map to the right.

There are currently plans to tear down these existing buildings and replace them with a massive mixed-use living and working community. The proposal is called Cherry Creek West (can be seen in more detail on page 41).

Alternatively, Cherry Creek Connect features a more sustainable approach to the revitalization of this area. By leaving the existing buildings, we can avoid excess construction costs and prevent building materials from going to waste. By adding floors to each building, we can create space for housing, as well as more commercial opportunities.

The top floor of building 1 will be a rooftop restaurant and bar with views of the city and Cherry Creek Trail. This building will also have three floors designated to parking because we will be removing hundreds of parking spaces in expanding the public green space by Cherry Creek Trail into a permanent park. The bottom two floors can be used for commercial purposes.

Buildings 2 and 3 will feature two floors each of housing, while the bottom floor will, again, be used as commercial space.

CHERRY CREEK MALL PROPOSAL

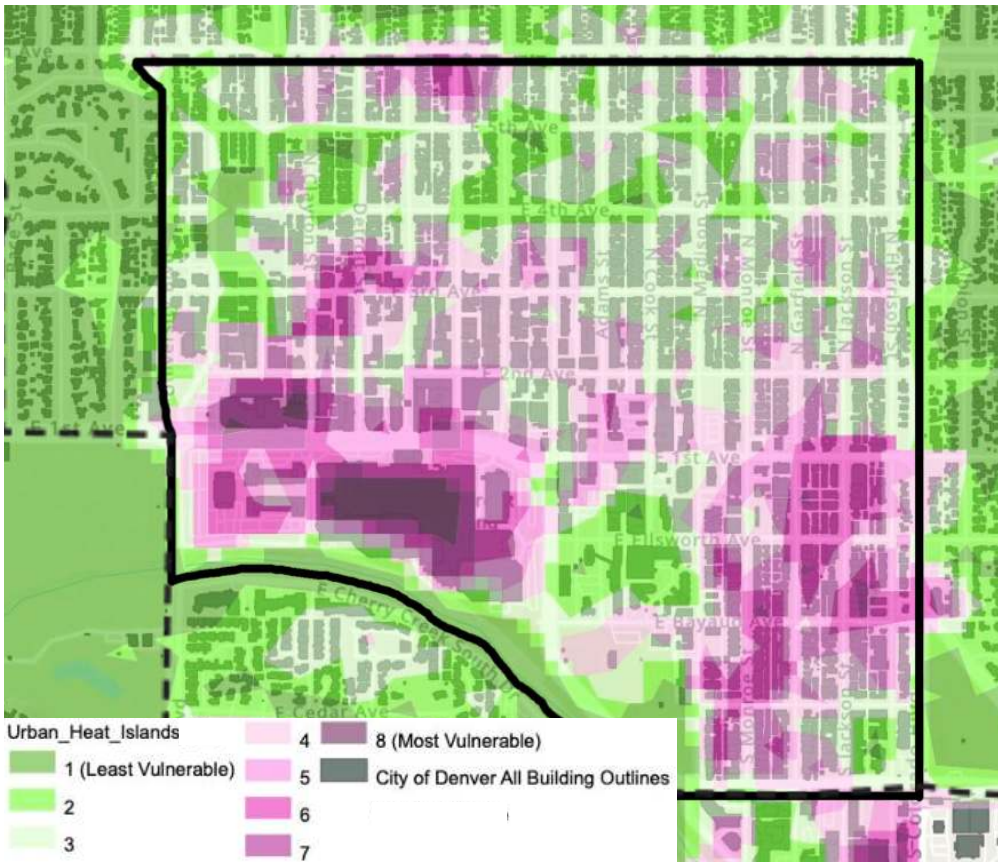


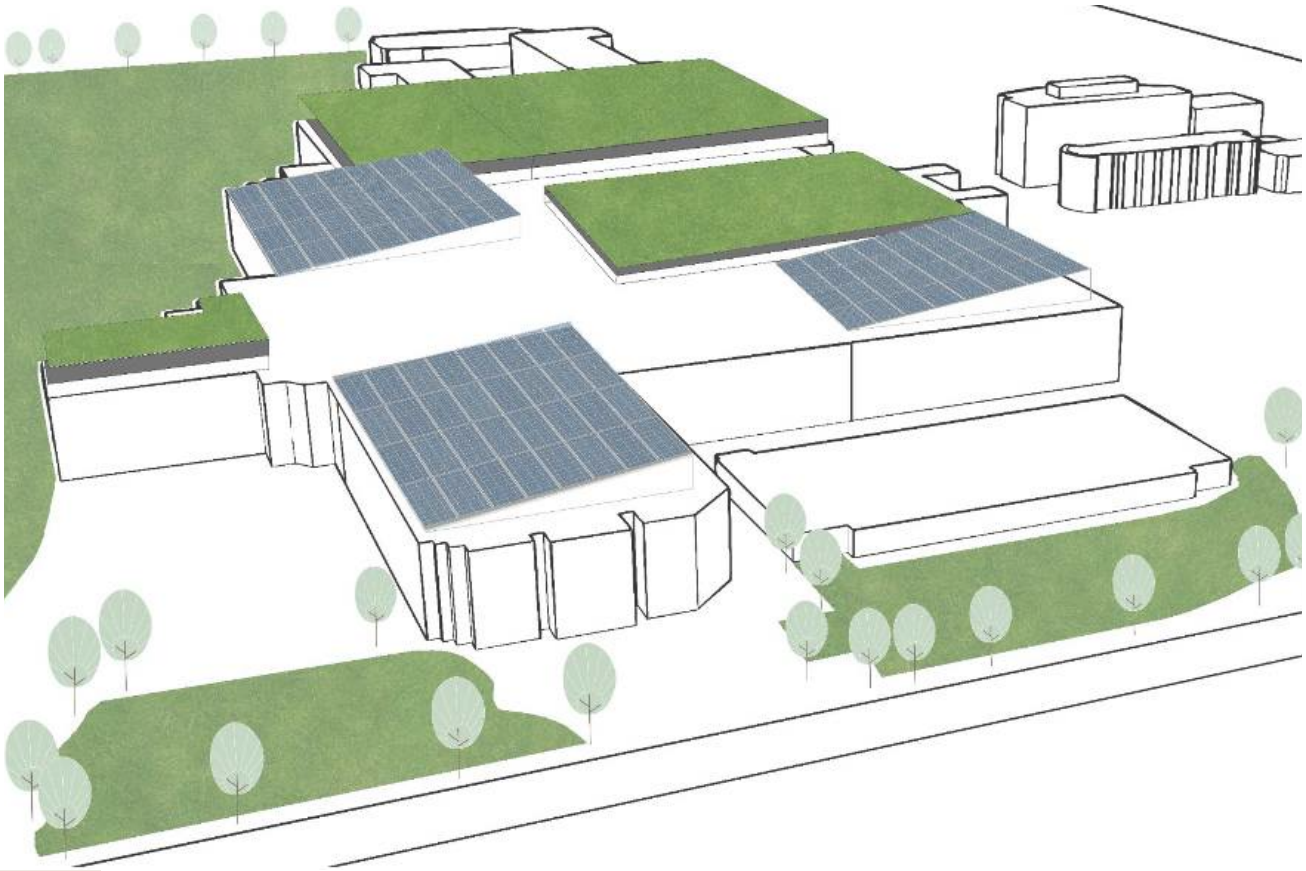


URBAN HEAT ISLAND EFFECT

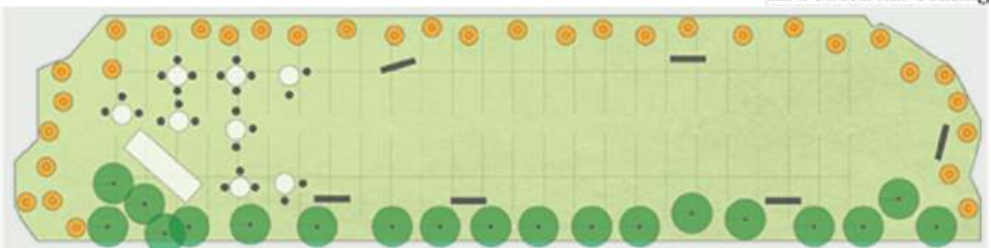
Urban heat is a major issue in Cherry Creek, especially around the mall. Dark roofs and massive parking lots absorb heat from the sun, making the mall up to 10 degrees warmer than the less vulnerable residential areas nearby.

Cherry Creek Connect will address urban heat around the mall by implementing a series of green roofs and solar panels, as well as converting excess parking into temporary parklets for residents.







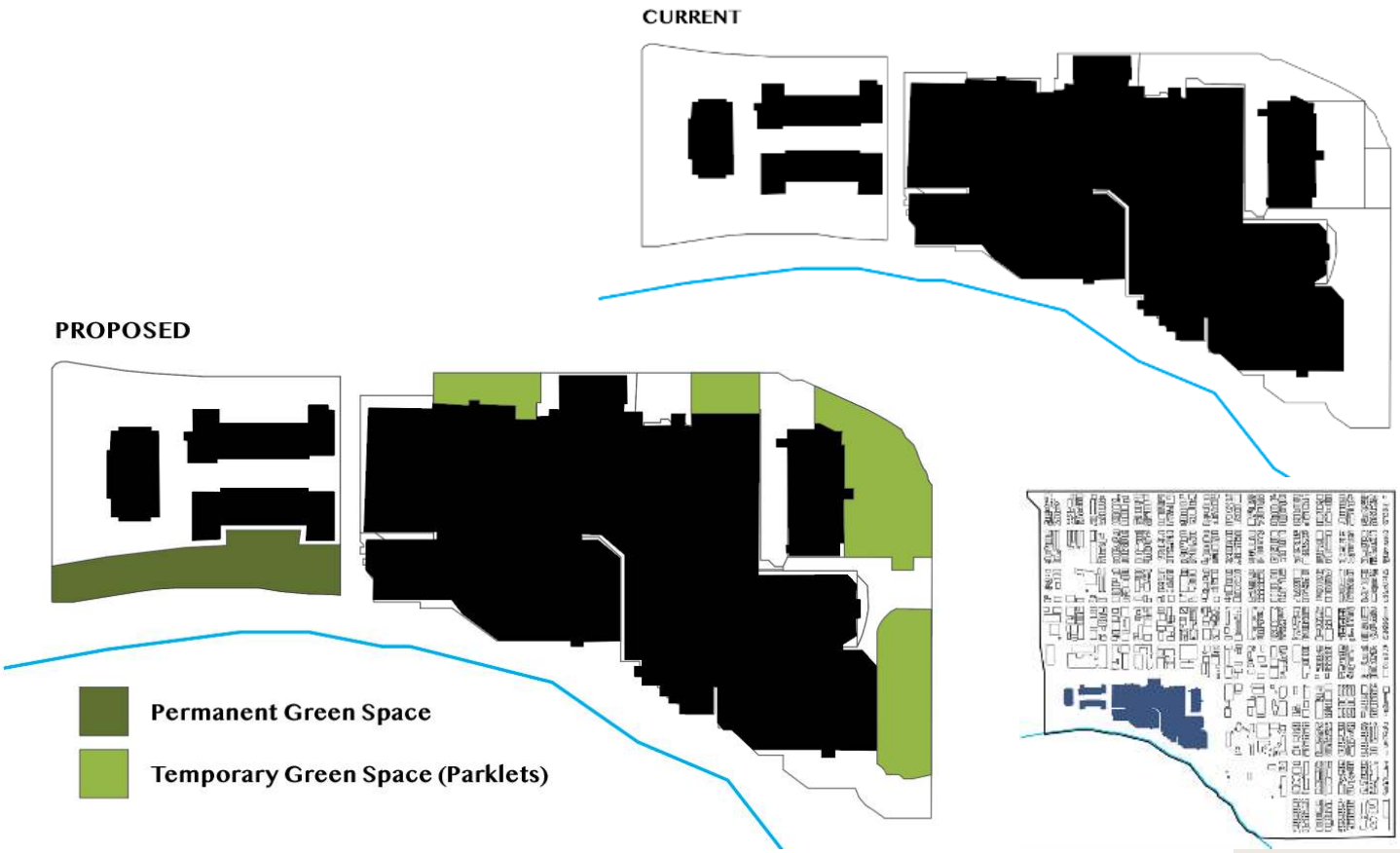


PARKLETS

Parklets are temporary public spaces often placed in parking lots or in place of street parking.

They help increase green space and improve urban heat by reducing the amount of unused parking and absorbing harsh sun.

These can also serve as general public space to bring the community together and enhance commercial experiences. For example, parklets can be used outside of small restaurants as outdoor seating.



PARKING AS A PUBLIC SPACE

Develop underutilized parking lots around Cherry Creek Mall into vibrant public parklets that prioritize both environmental sustainability and community well-being. These spaces will help mitigate the urban heat island effect and will offer welcoming areas for social interaction, rest, and recreation. This intervention not only cools the surrounding microclimate but also reclaims valuable land.





EXPANDED GREEN SPACE

A new green space will replace an underutilized parking lot near the Cherry Creek Mall, reconnecting the built environment with the natural landscape along the creek. The park will act as a green corridor connecting the new mixed-use space just East of the Mall. It acts as both a climate buffer and a social hub, connecting nature to the rich commercial district of Cherry Creek.





BUILDING EXPANSION

Density Considerations: *The area is transitioning from primarily low-rise residential to mixed-use, allowing for denser developments that combine living spaces with retail, office, and public uses.*

Key Zoning Areas: *The zones around Cherry Creek Shopping Center (G-MU-8) and along key commercial streets like Milwaukee St. (G-MS-5) are likely to see higher-density development due to their prime location near shopping and transit.*

Zone District	**Primary Use**	**Max Height**	**FAR** (Floor Area Ratio)
General Mixed Use - 5 stories	Multi-Unit Residential	5 stories	1.0 - 2.5
General Mixed Use - 8 stories	Mid-Rise Mixed Use	8 stories	2.3 - 3.0
General Main Street- 5 stories	Main Street Mixed Use	5 stories	2.5
General Residential Office- 3 stories	Residential Office	3 stories	1.0
General Residential High Density- 3 stories	Row House Residential	3 stories	0.75
General Residential Mixed Use- 5 stories	Residential Mixed Use	5 stories	1.5 - 2.0
Planned Unit Development	Custom Mixed Use	Varies	Varies

Planning for Growth: *As Cherry Creek grows, more zoning districts like G-RX-5 and PUDs will facilitate mixed-use and transit-oriented developments, aligning with urban renewal and environmental sustainability goals.*

Housing Type	Estimated Units/Acre	Typical Locations
Apartments, Condos	60 - 100	1st Ave Monroe St East Cherry Creek
Mixed Use Podium Buildings	100 - 150	Circa Cherry Creek Shopping Center
Commercial, Residential	60 - 120	2nd Ave 3rd Ave Milwaukee St
Duplexes, Small Offices	20 - 30	Josephine St Garfield St
Rowhomes, Townhomes	15 - 25	Clayton St Adams St
Residential, Retail Mix	50 - 75	1st Ave Cherry Creek North Dr
Varies (by plan)	Varies	Cherry Creek Shopping Center

COMMERCIAL EXPANSION

5TH AND JOSEPHINE

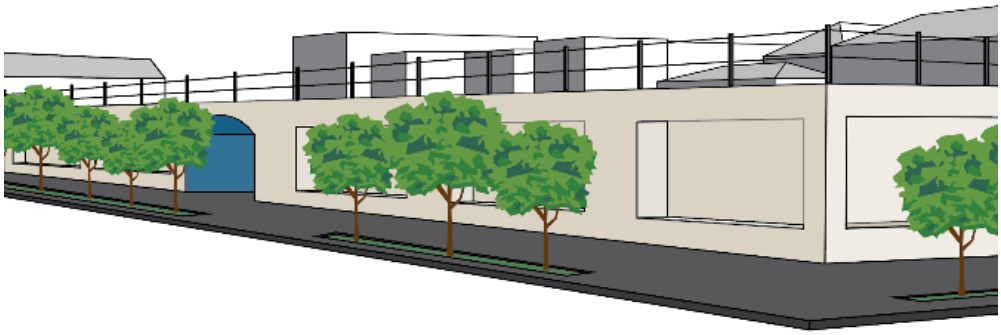
7,977 Total Sqft

0.1 Acres

Parking- Street 50 recommended

75% AMI





5TH AND MADISON

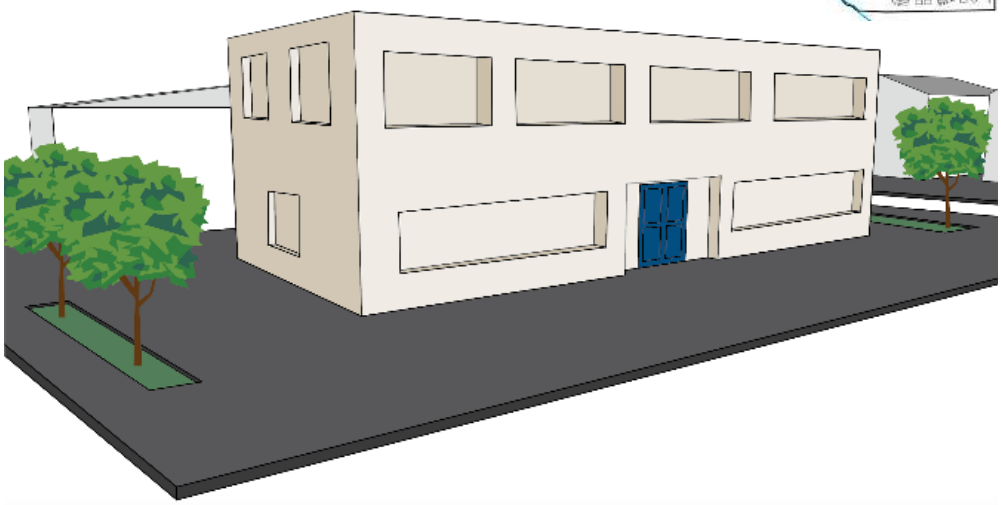
14,297 Total Sqft

0.32 Acres

Parking- Street 40 recommended

62% AMI





COMMERCIAL EXPANSION



4TH AND MADISON

26,000 Total Sqft

0.49 Acres

Parking- Street 45 recommended

76% AMI







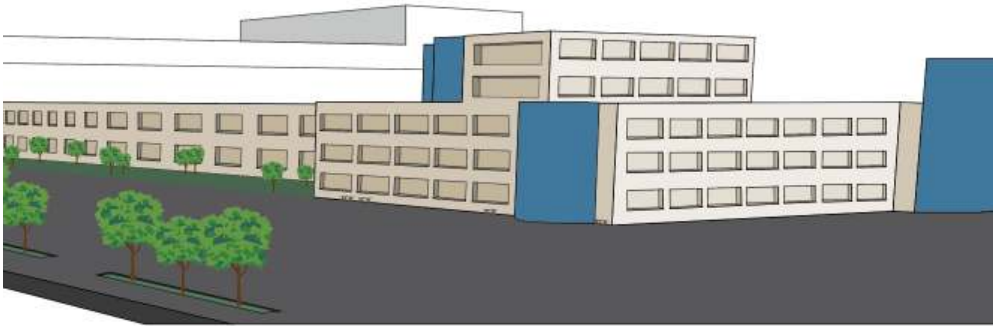
1ST AND COLUMBINE

19,297 Total Sqft

0.32 Acres

Parking- Street 45 recommended

76% AMI





MIXED-USE EXPANSION

BAYUD AND STEELE

478,659 Total Sqft

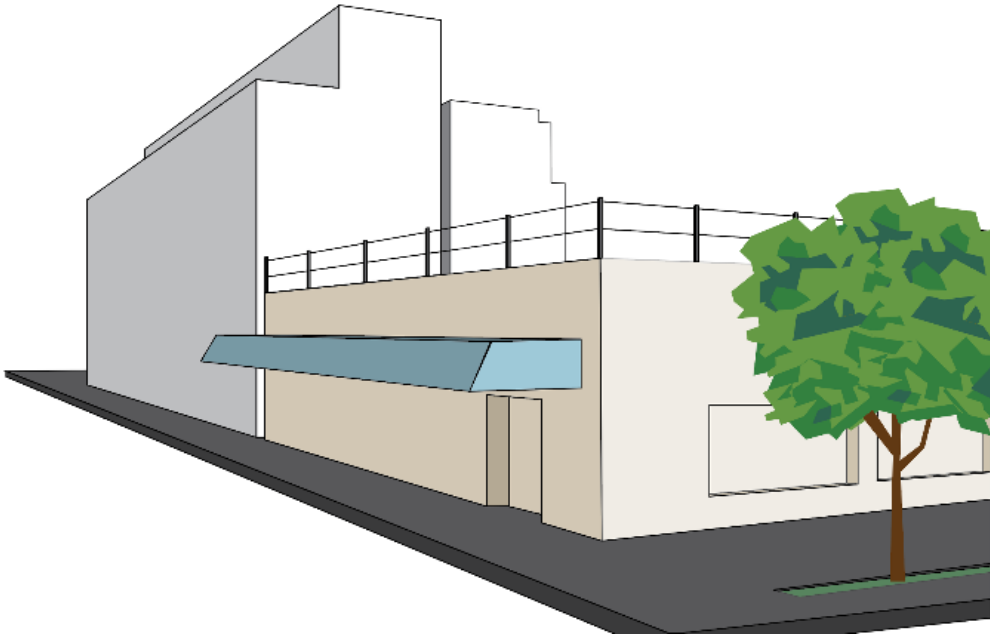
6.98 Acres

Parking- Street 66 recommended

Residential Density- 40%

86% AMI





4TH AND JOSEPHINE

6,886 Total Sqft

0.15 Acres

Parking- Street 40 recommended

Residential Density- 70%

75% AMI





MIXED-USE EXPANSION



ELLSWORTH AND MONROE

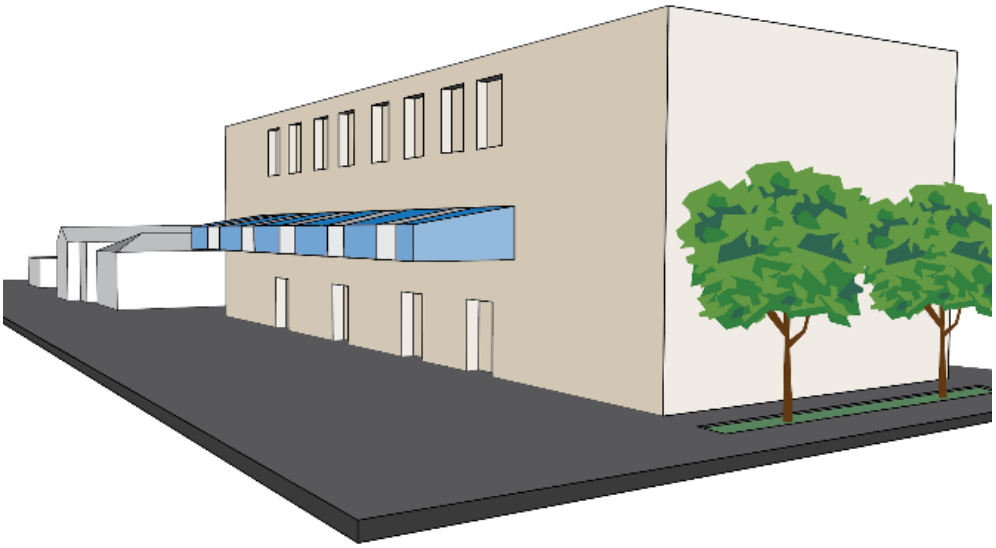
30,869 Total Sqft

1.3 Acres

Parking- Street 68 recommended

Residential Density- 40%

60% AMI







BAYUD AND COLORADO

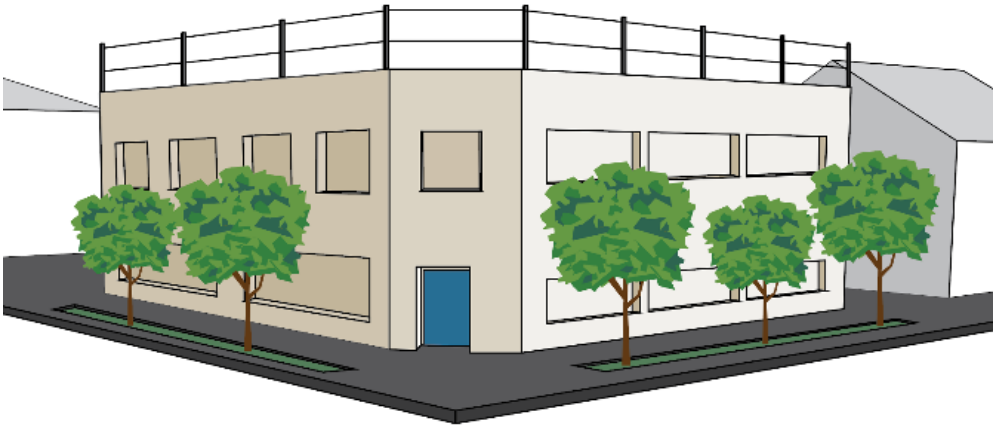
39,214 Total Sqft

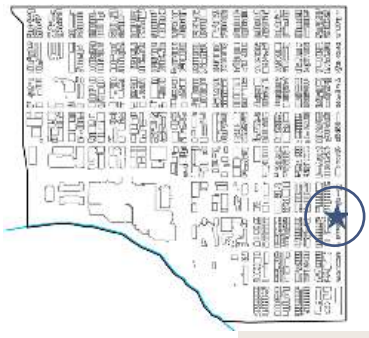
0.7 Acres

Parking- Street 70 recommended

Residential Density- 40%

78% AMI





EXISTING CONNECTIVITY

Current public transportation is costly and inefficient. Most attractions near the Cherry Creek neighborhood take over 15 minutes to access via transit with most of that time being used to walk to transit stops.

The map to the right shows the locations of many nearby attractions as named below.



WHAT ARE WE TRYING TO CONNECT TO?

1. Cheesman Park, Denver Botanic Gardens, Congress Park
2. Pulaski Park, Cranmer Park, Burns Park
3. Cherry Creek Mall, Cherry Creek Trail, new park/building development
4. Lindsley Park, various hospitals, AMC theaters



CONNECTIVITY INTERVENTIONS



EXISTING INFRASTRUCTURE

Current bus routes follow the perimeter of the site, but don't generally expand throughout the site. One bus route reaches the mall area, but still does not access a majority of the residential blocks in the neighborhood.

Bike lanes also only access a few residential areas in addition to the mall. This leads to unsafe conditions for bikers and prevents residents from using sustainable modes of transit.



PROPOSED INFRASTRUCTURE

Cherry Creek Connect aims to improve access to bus stops and bike lanes, especially in residential areas.

The project will implement a new set of Bus Rapid Transit (BRT) lanes around the mall to increase efficiency and slow other lanes down, increasing safety.

9 *additional bike lanes*

5 *micro-mobility hubs*

3 *BRT priority lanes*

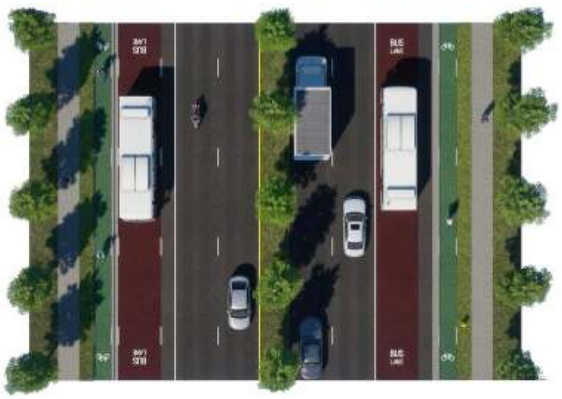
FIRST AVENUE: BEFORE



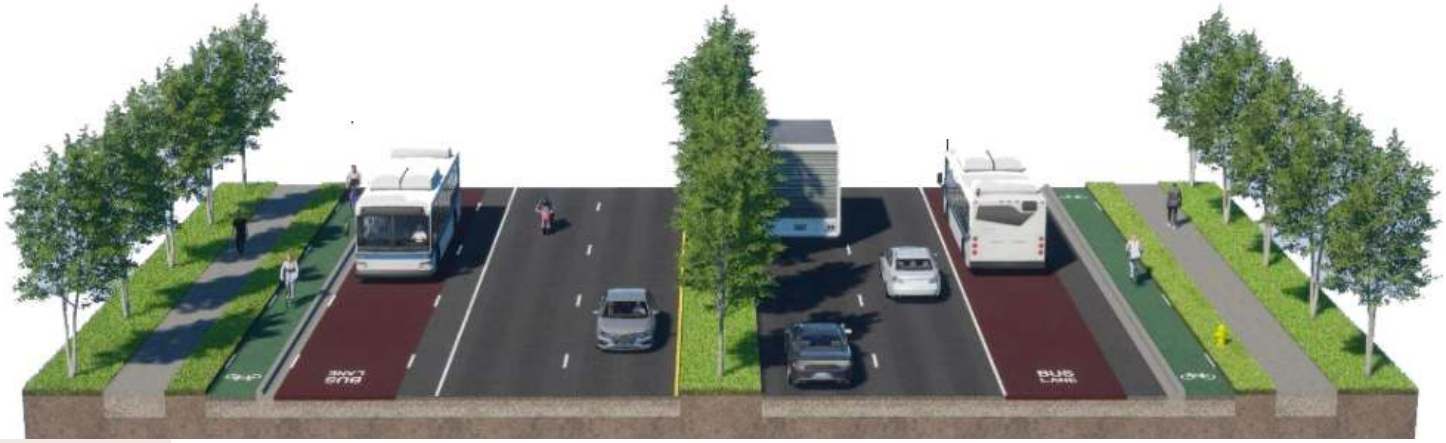




FIRST AVENUE: AFTER







UNIVERSITY AVE & JOSEPHINE ST: BEFORE







UNIVERSITY AVE & JOSEPHINE ST: AFTER







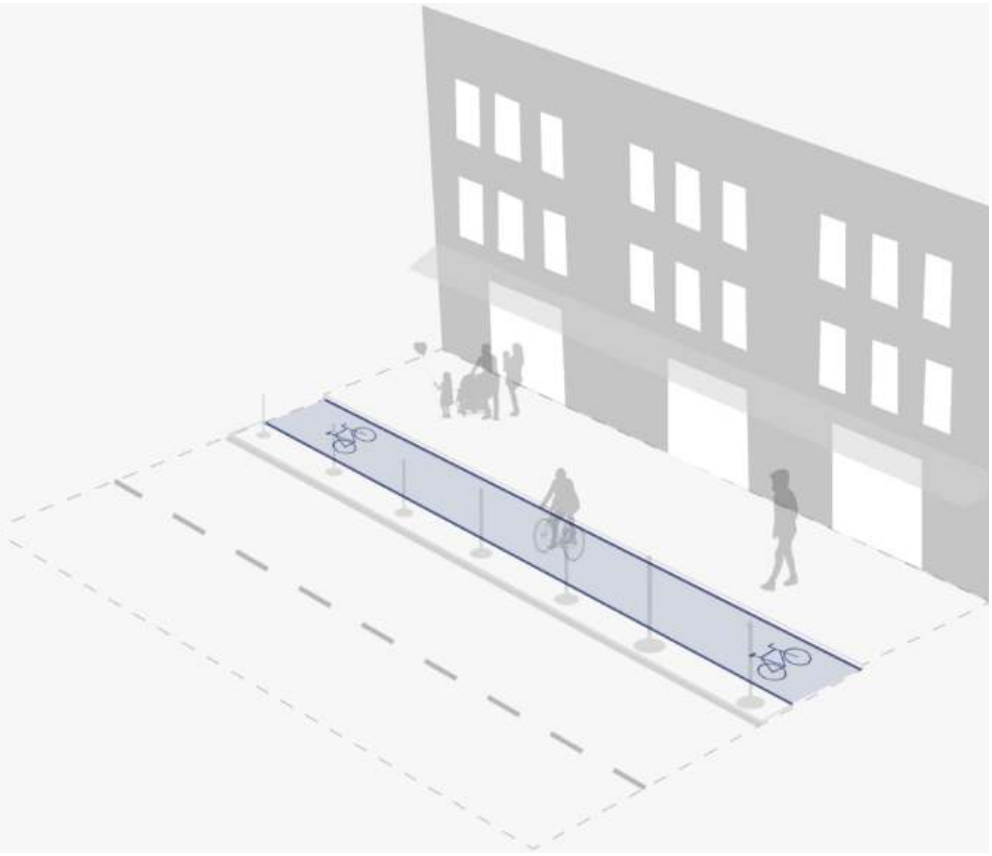
MICRO-MOBILITY HUBS

Micro-mobility hubs are designated spaces where people can access transportation options like bikes, e-scooters, and e-bikes. They often also include charging stations, parking spaces, and occasionally repair services.

Each hub is located near a transit stop or in a busy urban area to make travel easier and reduce car use.





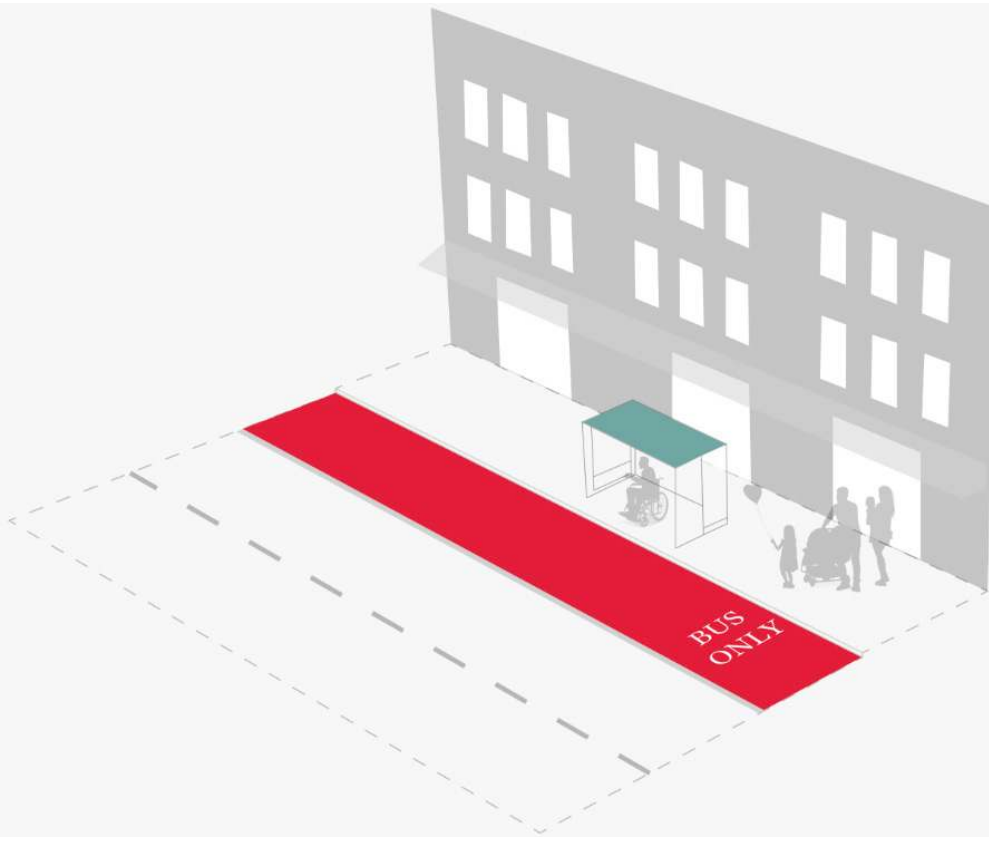


PROTECTED BIKE LANES

Protected bike lanes will be implemented throughout the residential and in some commercial areas.

This will encourage residents to use more active and sustainable transportation.

Bike accidents in Cherry Creek are a prominent issue. Adding protected bike lanes will ensure the safety of residents while promoting sustainable transportation.



BRT LANES

Bus Rapid Transit (BRT) Lanes can be added along major roads near the mall. This acts as a road diet, slowing other cars down and increasing safety, while also increasing the efficiency of public transportation in the site.

These will be placed along First Avenue, University Avenue, and Josephine Street. All three of these streets are currently busy roads. Adding the BRT lane would prioritize public transit and incentivize people to use the bus instead of driving.

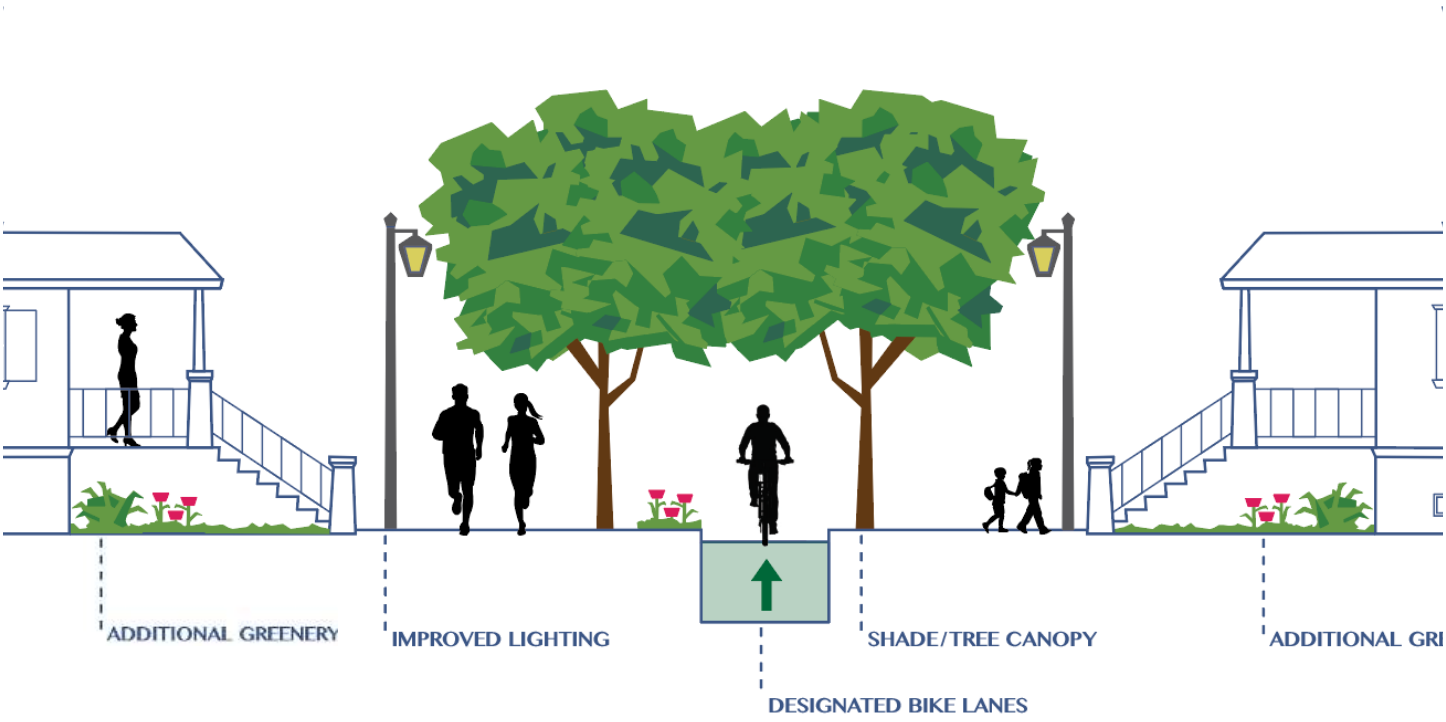
CONNECTIVE GREEN ALLEYWAYS

By implementing green alleyways throughout the neighborhood, we can create opportunities for active transportation throughout the neighborhood. Residents can walk safely from place to place.

They are strategically placed to connect existing green spaces, as well as our new developments.



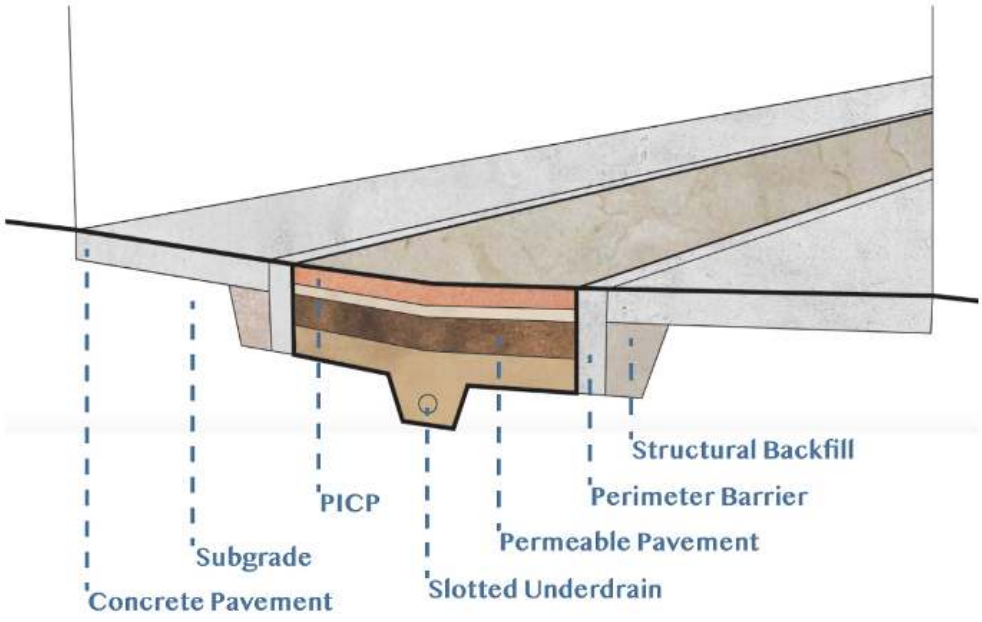




PERMEABLE PAVEMENT

Permeable pavement can help us manage stormwater and flood risks in the neighborhood. It can also be more attractive in appearance, drawing pedestrians into the space.

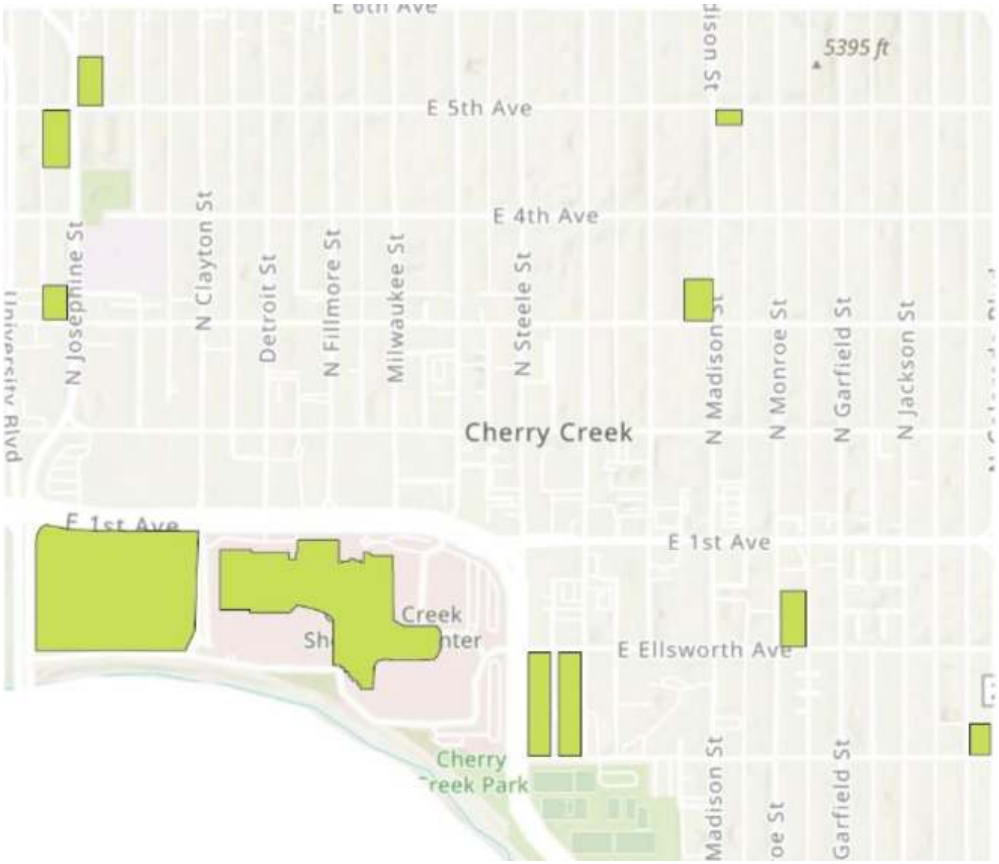
To the right is a diagram showing the materials we can use to implement these permeable pavements in the connective alleyways between buildings.



ROOF INTERVENTION LOCATIONS

Solar panels, green roofs, and roof common spaces will be added throughout the commercial areas along with some residential (mostly solar panels here) and primarily at the Cherry Creek Shopping Center. Urban heat is most prominent here due to dark roofs that absorb heat.

These interventions will decrease vulnerability of urban heat island effect by reflecting and utilizing heat from the sun.



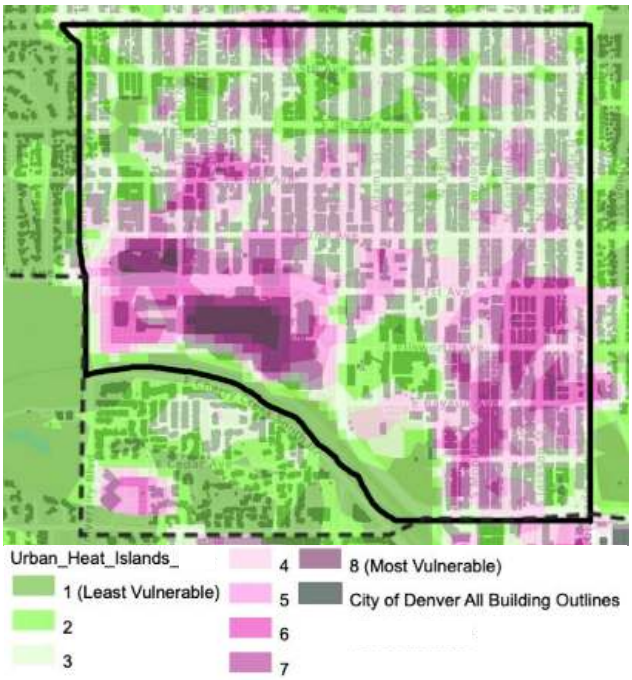
URBAN HEAT ISLAND EFFECT

Cherry Creek is among Denver's top 10 most heat-absorbent areas with 67% of surfaces being impervious. This heavily contributes to elevated temperatures, increasing heat-related health risks, and increased energy consumption.

Implementing green infrastructure strategies such as green roofs and reflecting building materials can mitigate these effects and increase urban resilience.

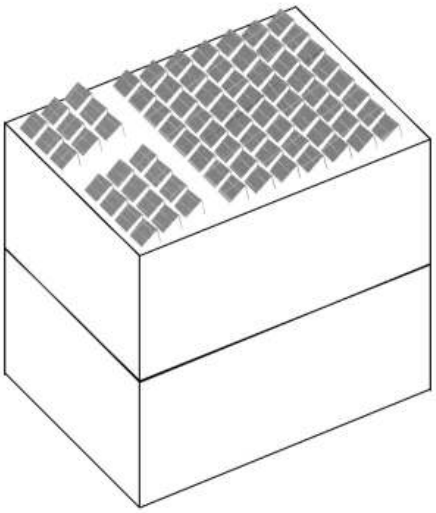
Given that Cherry Creek is so high in impervious surface coverage in Denver, it is crucial that interventions here are prioritized along with the other heat-absorbent areas in the city.

Cherry Creek Connect will implement solar panels, green roofs, and rooftop public spaces to mitigate the urban heat and increase livability in the city.



ROOF INTERVENTIONS

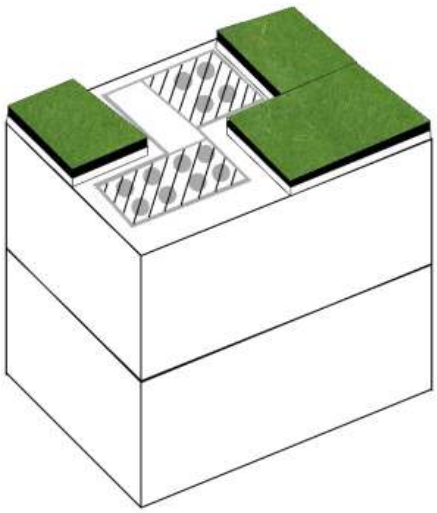
SOLAR PANELS





Solar panels *can help mitigate urban heat by reducing the amount of heat-absorbing surfaces in cities. Traditional rooftops absorb heat, raising temperatures of the building and around it, but solar panels can provide shade and reflect some sunlight while also absorbing some to use as a clean energy source. This reduces need for less clean energy like natural gas which harm the planet. Solar panels are more efficient and less harmful.*

MULTI-COURSE GREEN ROOF & PUBLIC SPACE

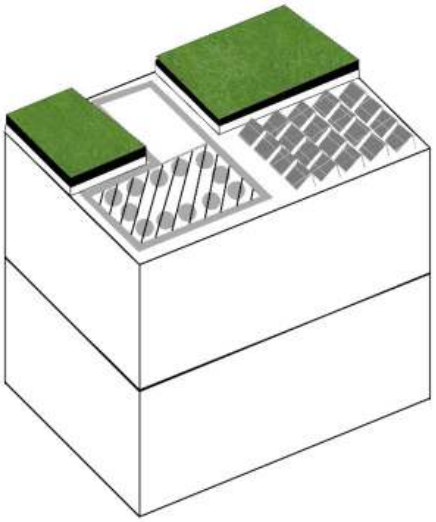




Green roofs *cover rooftops with vegetation which provides natural insulation to the building and prevents heat from being absorbed. They improve air quality and reduce energy consumption while also increasing biodiversity. All of these make cities more resilient to rising temperatures and urban heat island effect.*

These are also generally more aesthetic than traditional roofing types.

MULTI-COURSE GREEN ROOF, PUBLIC SPACE, & SOLAR PANELS





Rooftop public spaces *help transform unused areas into vibrant, multifunctional places for residents and visitors. This can reduce crowding at street level, promote community interaction, and provide access to nature even in dense cities.*

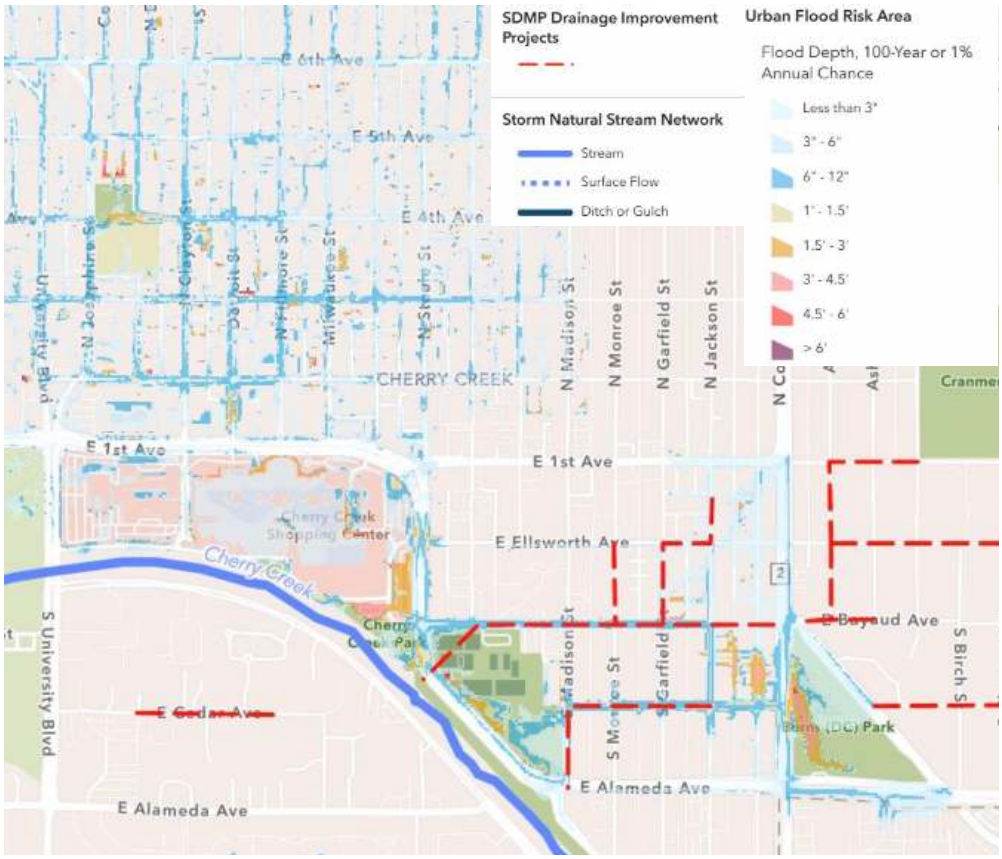
When designed properly, they can also address urban heat and improve environmental sustainability in large cities.

FLOOD RISK

Cherry Creek is vulnerable to flooding around Cherry Creek and Cherry Creek Trail. The mall is also directly next to these which puts it at a higher risk.

There are a number of planned drainage improvement projects near the creek and just outside of the neighborhood boundaries.

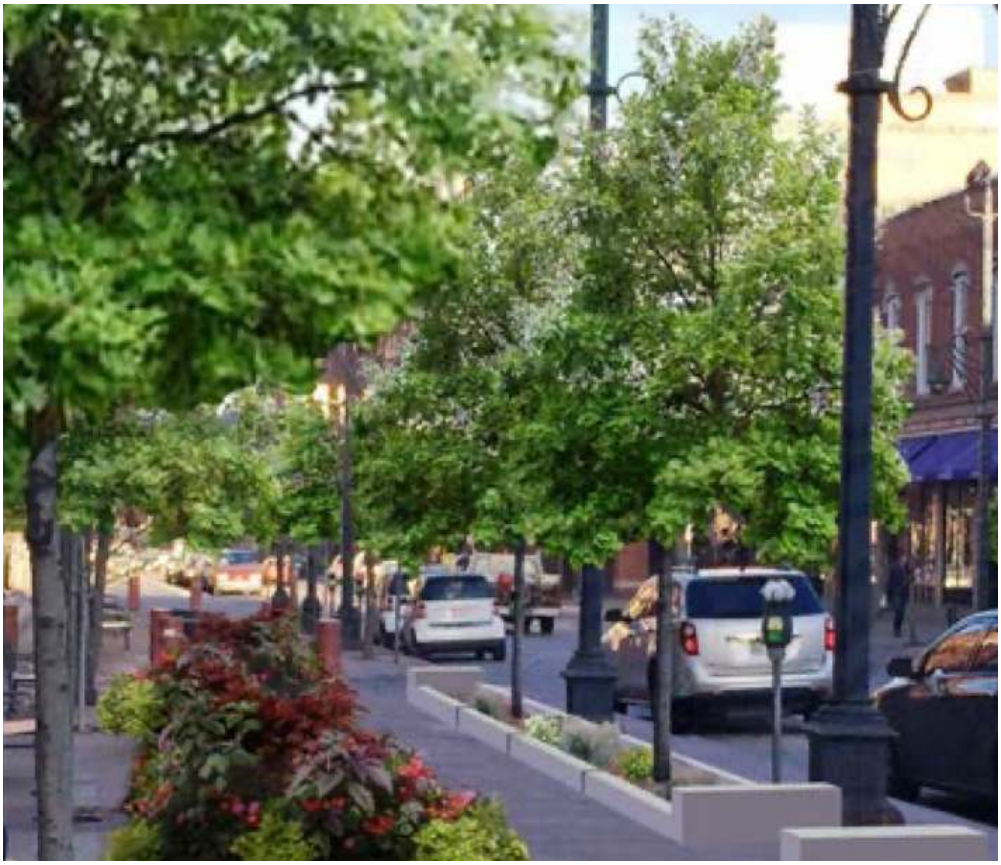
Minor flood risk is spread throughout the neighborhood which will be addressed in our stormwater management project.



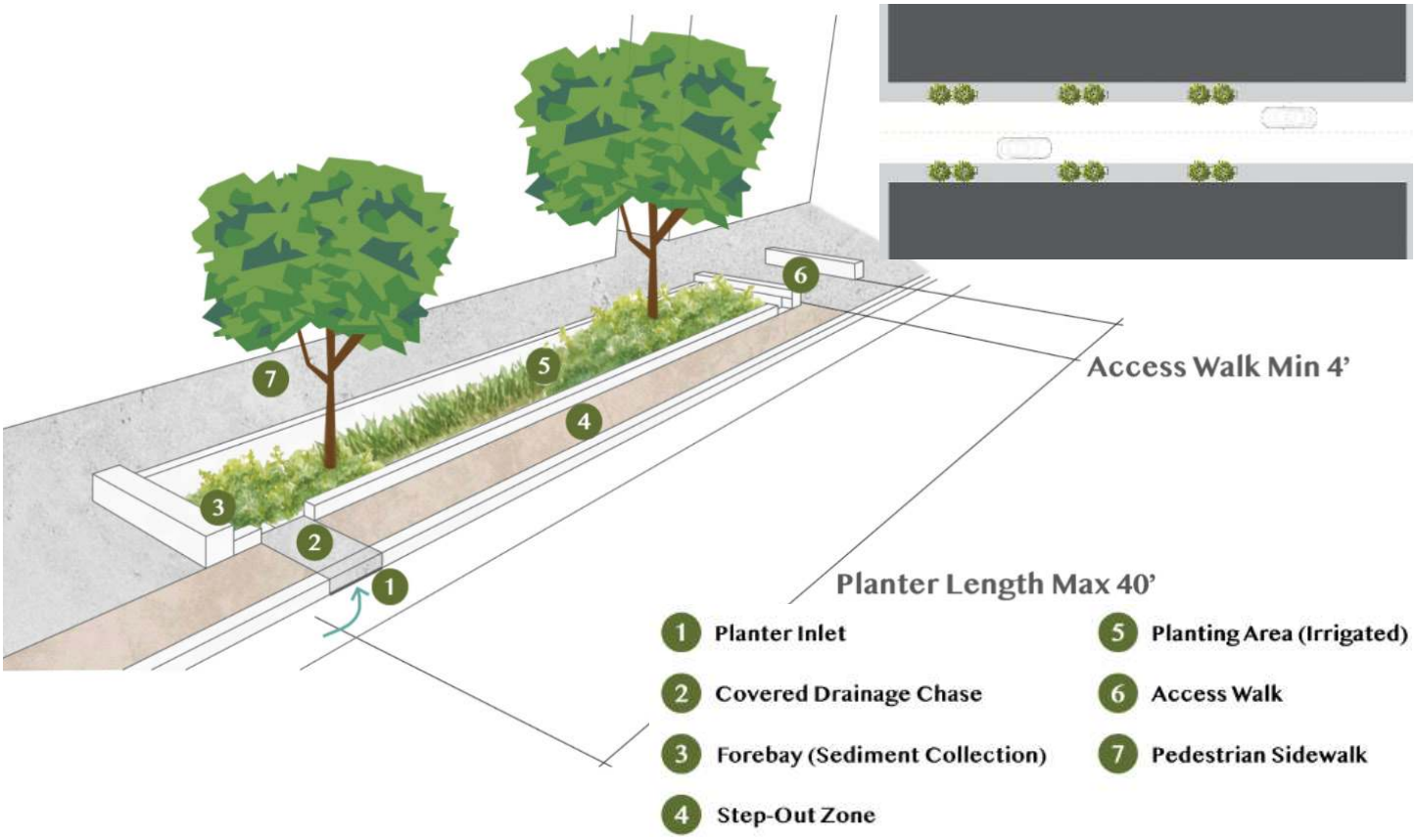
STORMWATER MANAGEMENT PLANTERS

Stormwater management planters are specialized bio-retention containers. They capture and filter water from impervious surfaces like sidewalks, roofs, and roads, preventing it from flooding and potentially polluting waterways.

Stormwater planters will be places throughout Cherry Creek, especially around the mall and most susceptible streets.



STORMWATER MANAGEMENT





FINAL DESIGN

PRIMARY INTERVENTIONS

CONCLUSION



CHERRY CREEK WEST PROPOSAL

Cherry Creek Shopping Center currently has three unused buildings surrounded by an abundance of unnecessary parking. While there are plans to tear down these structures and replace them with a massive mixed-use community called Cherry Creek West (detailed on page 41), Cherry Creek Connect offers a more sustainable alternative.

By building upon the existing buildings, we can reduce waste from discarded materials and avoid excess construction costs. Adding floors to each building instead would create new opportunities for housing and expanded commercial space.

One building would feature a rooftop restaurant and bar overlooking Cherry Creek Trail and the Cherry Creek neighborhood, three floors of parking to offset the hundreds of parking spaces that will be removed for an expanded permanent park along the trail, and two lower floors dedicated to commercial use. The other two buildings would each include two floors of housing and commercial space on the ground level.

Additionally, Cherry Creek Connect would tackle the significant issue of urban heat—caused by dark roofs and large parking lots that make the mall area up to 10 degrees warmer than nearby residential zones—by implementing green roofs, installing solar panels, and converting excess parking into temporary parklets for residents.



BUILDING EXPANSION

Cherry Creek Connect has a major focus on the expansion of commercial and mixed use areas. We will maximize expansion using existing zoning (expanding to the maximum height restrictions), as well as develop on any open lots we see potential in.

Cherry Creek is transitioning from primarily low-rise residential to a mixed-use neighborhood, allowing for denser developments that combine living, retail, office, and public spaces. Key zoning areas, such as those around the Cherry Creek Shopping Center (G-MU-8) and along major commercial streets like Milwaukee Street (G-MS-5), have potential for higher-density growth due to their proximity to existing shopping and transit.

As the area continues to evolve, additional zoning districts like G-RX-5 and PUDs will support mixed-use and transit-oriented developments, advancing both urban renewal and environmental sustainability goals.

This vertical expansion will allow for about 124,000 square feet of growth. Utilizing currently vacant lots will provide an opportunity for about 225,000 square feet of growth. These expansions in combination with implementing and incentivizing ADUs in low-density residential areas will create an opportunity for around 471,000 square feet of total expansion between commercial and residential.



EXPANDED GREEN SPACE

Cherry Creek neighborhood overwhelmingly lacks green space with the exception of Cherry Creek and Cherry Creek Trail nestled behind the large mall development. Improving the access to green space while also reducing the amount of excess parking near the mall will attract residents and bring the area back to life.

Parklets are temporary public spaces, often placed in parking lots or in place of street parking, that increase green space, reduce urban heat by absorbing harsh sun, and provide areas for community gathering.

Around Cherry Creek Mall, underutilized parking lots will be transformed into vibrant public parklets that prioritize both environmental sustainability and community well-being. These spaces will help mitigate the urban heat island effect, cool the surrounding microclimate, and offer welcoming areas for social interaction, rest, and recreation.

A new green space will also replace an underused parking lot near the mall, reconnecting the built environment with the natural landscape along Cherry Creek. Acting as a green corridor, this park will link the new mixed-use development east of the mall to the broader Cherry Creek area, serving as both a climate buffer and a lively social hub that enhances the rich commercial character of the neighborhood.

CONCLUSION

The vision for Cherry Creek is to create a modern, sustainable, and inclusive neighborhood that fosters a strong sense of community. The future of Cherry Creek will feature tree-lined streets, easy access to parks, and vibrant public spaces that encourage social interaction. A major design priority is reducing reliance on cars by introducing clean, efficient, and user-friendly transit options, making it easier for residents and visitors to navigate the area sustainably.

Addressing the Urban Heat Island Effect is another key goal. Cherry Creek Connect will incorporate green infrastructure, including tree planting, green roofs, shaded walkways, and pocket parks, to lower temperatures, improve air quality, and enhance stormwater management. These green features will make the neighborhood more comfortable, beautiful, and resilient throughout the year.

Connectivity will be central to Cherry Creek's success, with a thoughtfully designed network of bike lanes, pedestrian pathways, and accessible public transit. This interconnected system will promote sustainable movement, minimize pollution, and create a neighborhood that is easy to explore on foot or by bike. Public spaces will serve as hubs for gathering, relaxation, and community building, reinforcing a strong neighborhood identity.

Finally, revitalizing the Cherry Creek Mall and its surrounding commercial areas will bring renewed energy to the heart of the community. The mall will transform into a dynamic, mixed-use destination, featuring retail, dining, public art, and events in a walkable, engaging environment. With a focus on green space, smart design, and a welcoming atmosphere, Cherry Creek is poised to become a thriving, future-ready neighborhood for generations to come.





ANNABELLA VERSAGGI

I took charge throughout the entirety of this project as the team leader--coordinating deadlines, delegating tasks, and ensuring cohesiveness within the group. I personally worked on research, creating diagrams, forming the conceptual plan, rendering our proposal, and compiling all of the information into this final report. This was a great opportunity to enhance my leadership skills and improve with softwares like InDesign, Photoshop, Adobe Illustrator, and SketchUp.



LEIGHTON WARNER

I led the creation of our StoryMap by bringing together all research, analysis, and designs into a cohesive and polished final product. I used Adobe Suite to refine graphics and visuals, and worked in ArcGIS Pro to produce custom maps that clearly communicated our revitalization strategies for Cherry Creek. I really enjoyed working on this project and learned a lot about combining mapping and storytelling to communicate a vision for urban revitalization.



TEAGUE ROARK

This project has been a great experience for me as my ability to adapt and learn quickly was utilized in map-making on ArcGIS, rendering on Lumion, and communicating with team members to reach deadlines efficiently. I really enjoyed working on a neighborhood nearby where I grew up, it was so inspiring to see what was possible in my career with urban planning and design.



PATRICK PETHYBRIDGE

I designed the 3D models in SketchUp for the current and proposed neighborhood features, including all commercial and residential buildings. I applied our team's analytical and conceptual diagrams throughout to visualize our design at the human scale. I learned that our work as urban planners is ambitious and practical at the same time, a balance I helped us achieve.



CAMRYN GERCHOW

I worked on designing infographics and charts to help bring our story maps to life. My contributions made the visuals clearer and more engaging.



STORYMAPS QR CODE: